



ENGLISH

READER



Name

Class Section



5

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(M.A. English)

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PREFACE



'English Reader' a new series of English text books comprising of eight books from I to VIII **following the pattern of NEP**. The series has been designed keeping in view the modern teaching, innovative and need-based learning of English at the primary and junior level. The main aim of the series is to guide the beginners in the proper way of understanding by giving them the knowledge of the basic and elementary concepts of English language.

The approach of these books is child oriented and activity based. These are designed to promote language development through various skills like comprehension, word building, written work, communication and discussion.

The texts included in the series have been carefully selected and graded. These are value-based and offer topics to suit every taste and interest. Special emphasis has been laid on the preservation of our rich heritage and the protection of the environment.

Exercises set at the end of each lesson will engage the students individually or in pairs or groups. It will instil in them the habit of independent thinking and also give them an equal opportunity to express their views, ideas and opinions. New words have been introduced in each lesson and their use explained with a view to enhance the vocabulary power of the students. It will encourage the students to use dictionary for learning new words and will also familiarise them with minute grammatical aspects of the language.

We sincerely believe that our efforts will be appreciated both by the teachers as well as the learners. Suggestions, if any, for improvement of the series will be thankfully acknowledged and incorporated in subsequent editions.

Author & Publisher



NATIONAL EDUCATION POLICY (NEP) 2020



UN SDGs

Ensuring the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) are supported and met by 2030.

The **National Education Policy (NEP) 2020**, as envisaged by the **Ministry of Education**, provided high quality education and educational opportunities to India that has more than one-third of its population under 20. The importance of **NEP 2020** for such a critical demographic group cannot be emphasised enough.



COGNITIVE CAPABILITIES

Developing cognitive capacities (illiteracy, numeracy, critical thinking and problem solving).

EXPERIMENTAL LEARNING

Learning by doing, nurturing rational thought and action, compassion and empathy, courage and resilience and developing a scientific temper.



EMOTIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Developing social, ethical, and emotional capacities and dispositions.



CLARITY OF CONCEPT

Emphasising on conceptual clarity, understanding in detail rather than rote learning.



CREATIVITY

Developing creative imagination with sound morals and ethical values.

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCY

Through Integrated Solutions
Promoting the extensive use of available technology to make learning more immersive.



MULTILINGUATION AND CULTURE

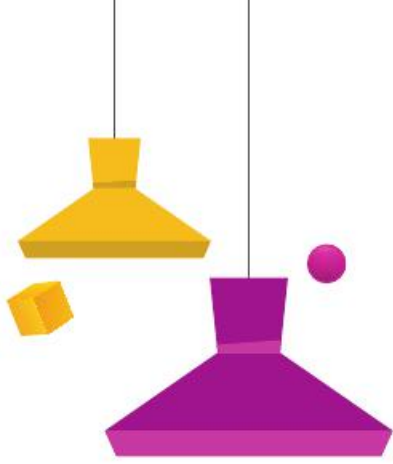
Promoting learning multiple language as understanding India's heritage and other.



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1

The Coming of Spring

How do I know that spring is here?
Because the world is full of cheer.
The crocuses and daffodils
Peep out from all the window sills;
The grass is getting soft and green;
The garden makes a pretty scene
Forsythia bushes all unfold
And show their blooms of fairy gold;
The tulips of my garden wall
Are getting beautiful and tall;
The birds are coming back to stay
And serenade us everyday.
The world is full of joy and cheer!
That's how I know that spring is here!



New Words to Learn



cheer – liveliness, peep out – show up, soft – tender, pretty – lovely, blooms – flowers,
unfold – open out, serenade – sing



ASSIGNMENT



Comprehension Skill

A. Multiple Choice Questions :

(Analytical Skills)

Tick (✓) the correct option :

1. The world is full of _____.

(i) bear

(ii) chair

(iii) dear

(iv) wheat

2. The _____ is getting soft and green.

(i) grass

(ii) rice

(iii) wheat

(iv) dal

B. Complete the following lines :

(Experiential Learning)

1. The crocuses _____

_____ window sills.

The grass _____

_____ pretty scene.

2. The birds are _____

_____ everyday.

The world _____

_____ is here!

C. Write 'T' for true and 'F' for false :

(Critical Thinking)

1. The world is full of cheer on the arrival of spring.

2. The crocuses and daffodils peep out from under the ground.

3. No flowers bloom in the spring.

4. The birds go away in the spring.

5. The world looks bright and beautiful in spring.

D. Answer the following questions :

(Writing Skills)

1. How does the poet know that the spring has come?

2. What peeps out from the window sills?

3. How does the garden look on the arrival of the spring?

4. Which flowers in the garden are getting beautiful and tall?

5. What do the birds do everyday?

Enhance Your Vocabulary

- Find out the words from the poem that rhyme with the words in column 'A' and write them in column 'B':

(Critical Thinking)

Column 'A'

- here
- green
- unfold
- wall
- cheer

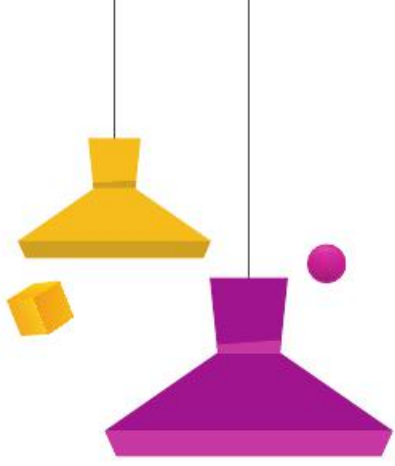
Column 'B'

Activity Time



- Write the all seasons name. You can take help of your teacher and parents :

(Creative Thinking)

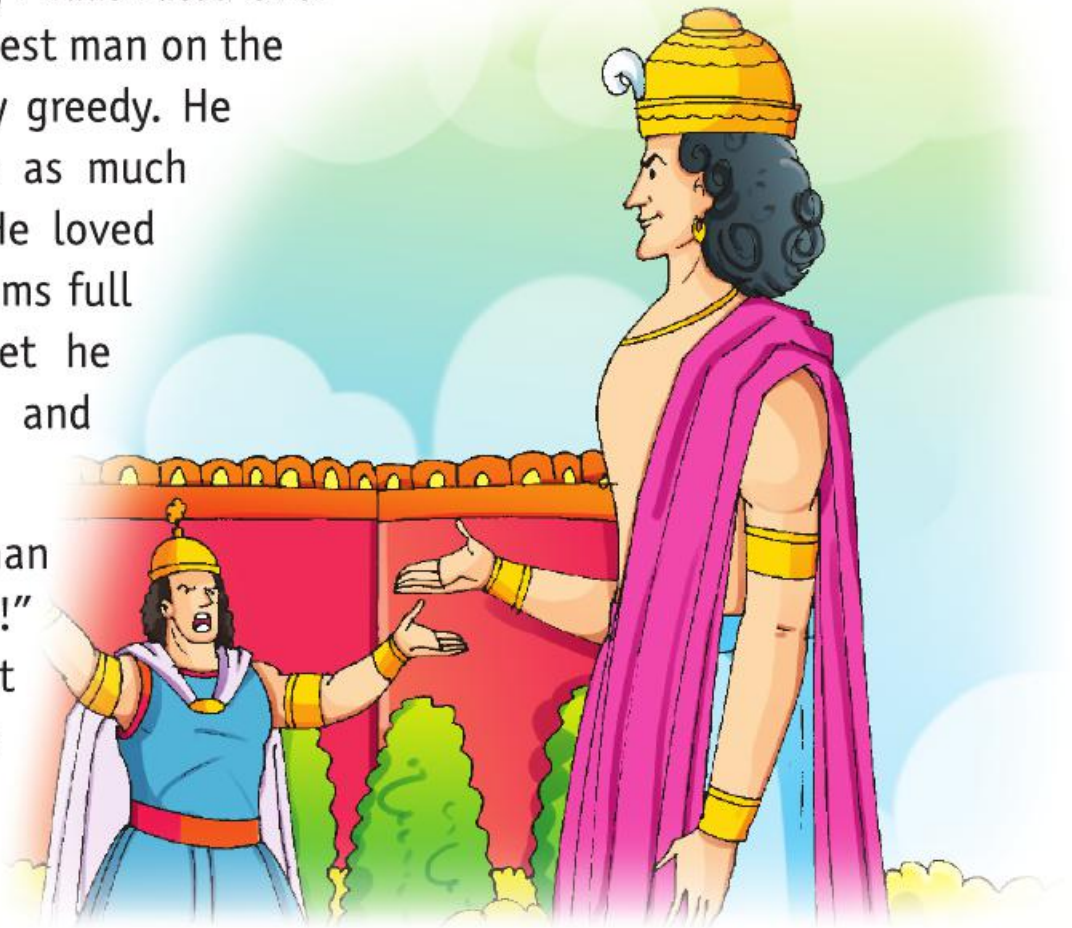


2

The Golden Touch

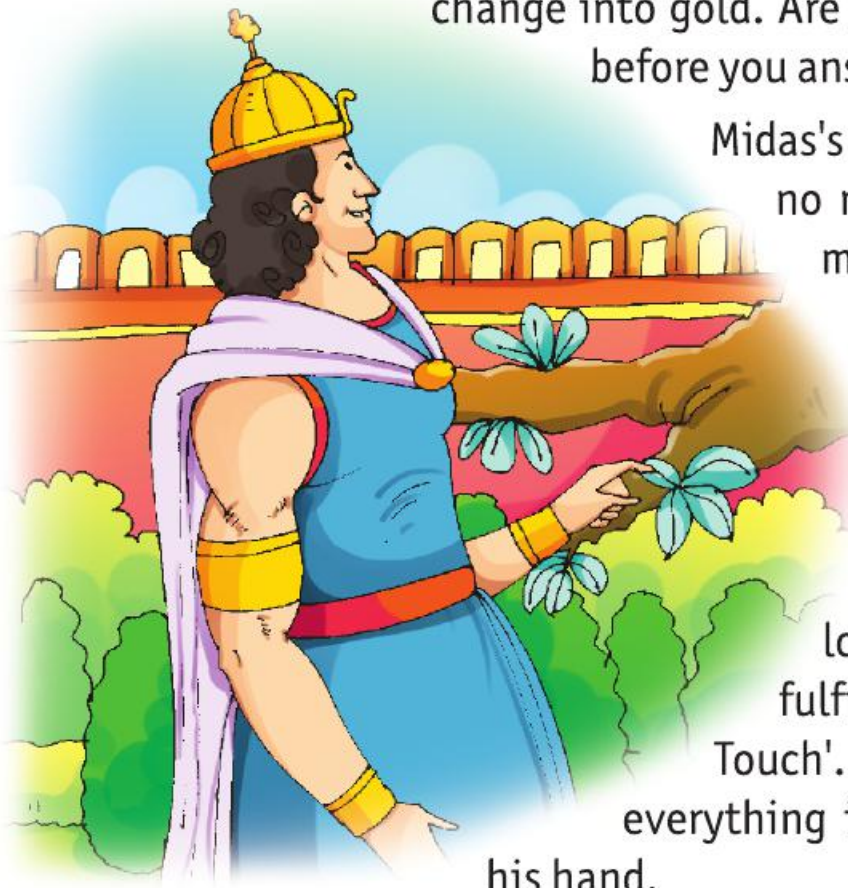
Once upon a time, King Midas ruled over Greece. He was the richest man on the earth. But he was very greedy. He always tried to amass as much wealth as he could. He loved gold. He had many rooms full of gold and silver, yet he wanted more, more and more.

"I love gold more than anything in the World!" He would often say "It is more beautiful to me than the flowers, the grass, the stars, the sun and everything else in the world. I want more and more gold."



One day, when Midas was wishing for more and more gold, an Angel heard him. He wanted to teach him a lesson. So, he appeared before Midas.

"Midas, you will have your wish fulfilled," he said. "Whatever you touch, will change into gold. Are you ready for it? Think over twice before you answer."



Midas's heart was filled with joy. "There is no need to think twice. Please grant my wish," said Midas.

"As you wish," said the Angel and smiled. He touched Midas with his Magic Wand and then vanished.

King Midas was very happy. His long cherished desire had been fulfilled. Now, he had got the 'Golden Touch'. He could now turn anything and everything into gold with the mere touch of his hand.

He was eager to test his newly acquired boon. So he rushed to his garden. He touched a leaf on a tree. At once, the tree and all its leaves turned into gold! "Oh! I have the golden touch!" Shouted Midas with great joy, "My dream is fulfilled, now I can get as much gold as I wish."

Midas ran back to his palace. He touched the pillars, the doorways the stairs and everything turned into gold.

By now, Midas was very hungry. So, he sat down to eat. The cooks brought choicest dishes for him and placed on the table. He touched the plate and the spoons on it and they turned into gold. Midas sat watching. He looked at the glass of water. He lifted it to his mouth. But, it also changed into gold. He then touched the food which also turned into pure gold.

Now, Midas cried out. He was hungry but couldn't eat anything. He was thirsty but couldn't drink water. Now, he was no longer a happy man. The boon had turned into a curse for him. He got up from his seat and cried out in

anguish, "I don't want the golden touch. Where are you Angel? Please take back your boon."

Just then, his little daughter came running into the room. To Midas, she was the most precious thing in the world after gold. She had a beautiful bunch of flowers in her hand.

"Father! Look at these pretty flowers!" She said and ran to him.

Midas tried to stop her, but it was too late. She touched him and at once turned into a laughing statue of solid gold. Midas cried out again, "Oh! Angel! Where are you? Please take back your boon."

Suddenly, the Angel appeared.

He smiled at Midas. "Midas, Are you happy now?" He asked, "You have the golden touch for which you had longed for."

Midas fell down on his feet weeping. "I don't want the golden touch. Please take it back," he cried.

"You foolish king!" Said the Angel. "There are many things in the world which are more valueable than all the gold in the world."

"Please forgive me. Now I understand that I was wrong," said Midas.

"Then, go to your garden, pick up a grass from your lawn and throw it into the river and everything will be same as before," said the Angel.



King Midas did as he was told. Once again, the golden grass was green. Now he touched the water, but nothing happened. He was very happy. He touched the golden trees. Once again they were green. Then he ran into the palace. His daughter's golden statue stood in the middle of the room. Midas took it in his arms. As soon as he did so, he heard his daughter's tinkling laughter. "Father!" Said the little girl and tears rolled down Midas' cheek.

"I was greedy so I thought that gold is the most precious thing in the world. But I have learnt the greatest lesson of my life. Now I have become wiser. I know that you, the trees and the sky are more dear to me than gold" said King Midas.

New Words to Learn



amass – accumulate, angel – representative of God, appeared – came, vanished – disappeared, eager – keen, acquired – obtained, choicest – best, boon – blessing, curse – nuisance, anguish – grief, Precious – loved, pretty – beautiful, turned into – changed, statue – effigy, longed for – wished, understand – appreciate, tinkling – ringing, dear – loveable



ASSIGNMENT



Comprehension Skill

A. Multiple Choice Questions :

(Analytical Skills)

Tick (✓) the correct option :

1. King Midas was the richest man of _____.

(i) Greece

☐

(ii) the Earth

☐

(iii) Europe

☐

(iv) Asia

☐

2. Midas was too fond of _____.

(i) money

☐

(ii) wealth

☐

(iii) gold

☐

(iv) silver

☐

3. One day, when Midas was wishing for more and more gold, _____ heard him.

(i) a fairy

(ii) an Angel

(iii) a giant

(iv) none of the above

4. He could now turn anything and everything into gold with the mere touch of his _____.

(i) wand

(ii) septre

(iii) hand

(iv) leg

B. Fill in the blanks :

(Experiential Learning)

1. He was the _____ man on the earth.

2. He appeared before _____.

3. His long _____ desire had been.

4. There are many things in the world which are more _____ than all the gold in the world.

5. Now he touched the water, but nothing _____.

C. Write 'T' for true and 'F' for false :

(Critical Thinking)

1. King Midas always tried to amass as much wealth as he could.

2. The Angel wanted to teach Midas a lesson. So, he appeared before him.

3. King Midas was eager to test his newly acquired boon.

4. Midas ran back to his palace. He touched the pillars, the doorways the stairs but nothing happened.

5. The cooks brought choicest dishes for him and placed on the table.

6. King Midas ate and drank to his heart's content.

7. His daughter's golden statue stood in the corner of the room.

D. Answer the following questions :

(Writing Skills)

1. Who was King Midas? Where did he rule?

2. What was the most precious thing in the world for King Midas?

3. Who fulfilled King Midas' wish? Was King Midas happy when his desire was fulfilled?

4. What difficulties did King Midas face when he sat down to eat?

5. Who came running into the room? What happened to her when she touched King Midas?

6. Why did King Midas ask the angel to take the boon back?

7. What lesson did King Midas learn in the end? What lesson do you learn from the story?

Enhance Your Vocabulary

A. Look for the meanings of the following words in the dictionary and write them alongside : (Critical Thinking)

- | | |
|-------------------|-------------------|
| 1. amass _____ | 2. fond of _____ |
| 3. appeared _____ | 4. vanished _____ |
| 5. eager _____ | 6. tinkling _____ |
| 7. precious _____ | |

B. Match the words in Column 'A' with their opposites in Column 'B' : (Phonics Skills)

'A'	'B'
1. Greedy	a. Took
2. Appeared	b. Unattractive
3. Brought	c. Sadness
4. Precious	d. Moderate
5. Pretty	e. Worthless
6. Forgive	f. Disappeared
7. Laughter	g. Blame

Let's Converse

- King Midas was a greedy man. Though he was the richest man on the earth yet he wanted to have more and more gold. An Angel came to know of it and wanted to teach him a lesson. He gave him the boon of 'Golden Touch'. In the beginning Midas was too happy but very soon it proved out to be a curse for him. He prayed to the Angel to take the boon back. Once again, the Angel granted his wish and made him a normal man. Now, work in pair and frame an imaginary conversation between King Midas and the Angel : (Communication Skills)

Angel : Midas, I have taken back the boon of 'Golden Touch'. Are you really happy now?

Midas : Oh yes, I am really happy.

Angel : But, _____

Midas : Then, I didn't know the importance of other things. I had thought that only gold can _____

Angel : _____

Midas : _____

Enhance Your Writing Skill

- In the beginning, Midas valued only gold in life. After the Angel blessed him with the boon of 'Golden Touch' he faced many difficulties. He also realized that gold alone cannot bring all happiness in life. Imagine that King Midas had written a diary entry the reasons of this great change. You have got the diary from somewhere. Now, describe, in your own words, the reasons he had mentioned in that diary. (Writing Skills)

Check Your Language Skill

Formation of Adjective

- Adjectives can be formed by adding suffices to a noun or verb. Read the following examples :

Example : blood + -y = bloody, music + -al = musical
cure + -able = curable, care + -free = carefree

Now, form Adjectives from the following nouns and verbs by adding a suitable suffix from the ones given in the box below : (Analyse)

-able	-ish	-en	-y	-al	-ed
-ous	-ful	-ing	-ive	-ic	-less

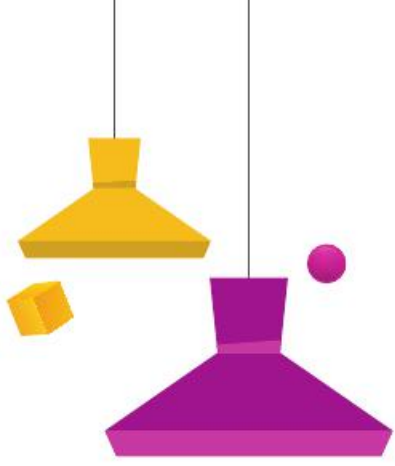
- power + _____ = _____
- job + _____ = _____
- power + _____ = _____
- artist + _____ = _____
- self + _____ = _____
- sun + _____ = _____
- love + _____ = _____
- act + _____ = _____
- volcano + _____ = _____
- self + _____ = _____

Activity Time



- Gold is a costly metal. It is found inside the earth. Since ancient times, some metals and stones are used in making jewellery. Discuss with your partner and name at least five such items which are used as precious materials : (Creative Thinking)

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____



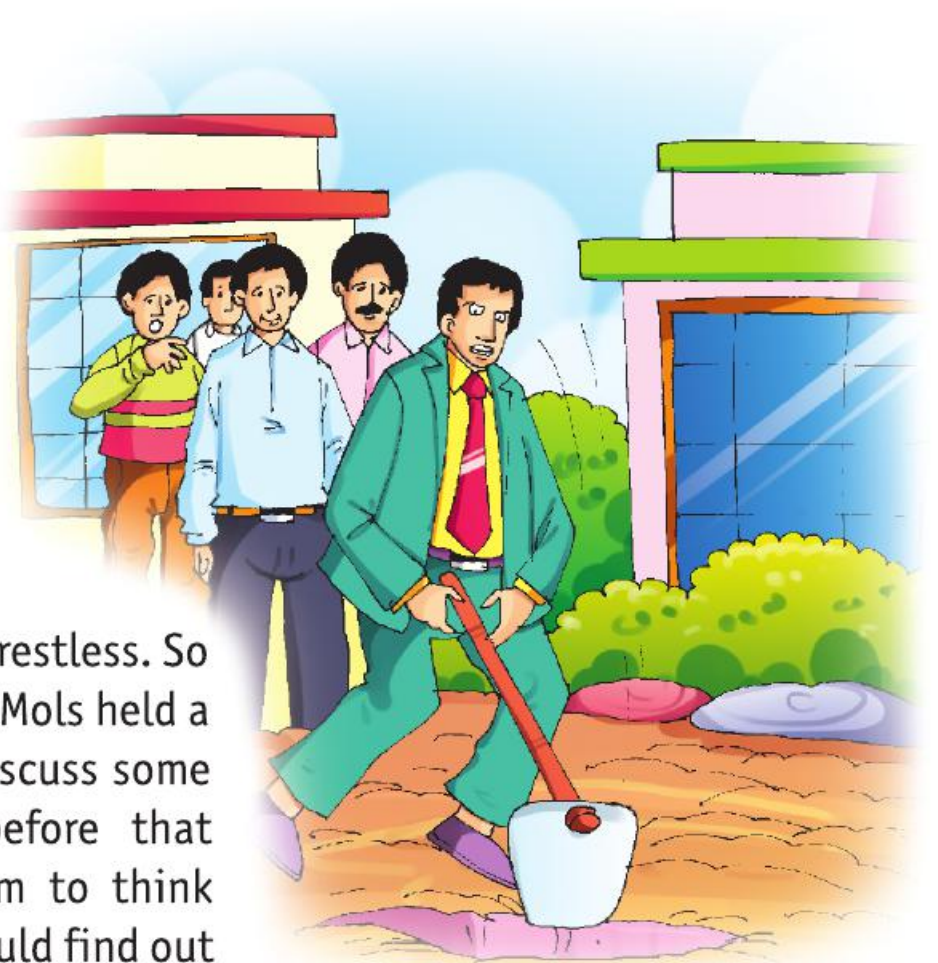
3

The Wise Men of Mols

Mols is a tiny island to the north of Denmark. The residents of the island were hard-working but it is not sure whether they were wise as well. However, they always loved to make funny stories about themselves.

For some days, the people there had no problem to solve and they were getting restless. So one day, all the wise men of Mols held a meeting. They wanted to discuss some important matters. But before that they had to find a problem to think about and only then they could find out a solution.

So, they all sat together in a circle, because they believed that sitting in a circle would help them think better. They nodded their heads and stroked their chins and thought and thought and thought.



They had thought for a very long time when suddenly Fritz, the wisest of them, shouted, "Yes! I have got an idea. We need a well in the village."

"Yes, yes, we badly need a well," cried the others in chorus. "We never thought of it before. But how could we get one?"

"That's very easy," said Jacob, another wise man of Mols. "We'll have to dig one."

"That's an excellent idea," said everybody.

"Digging a well is not at all a difficult job."

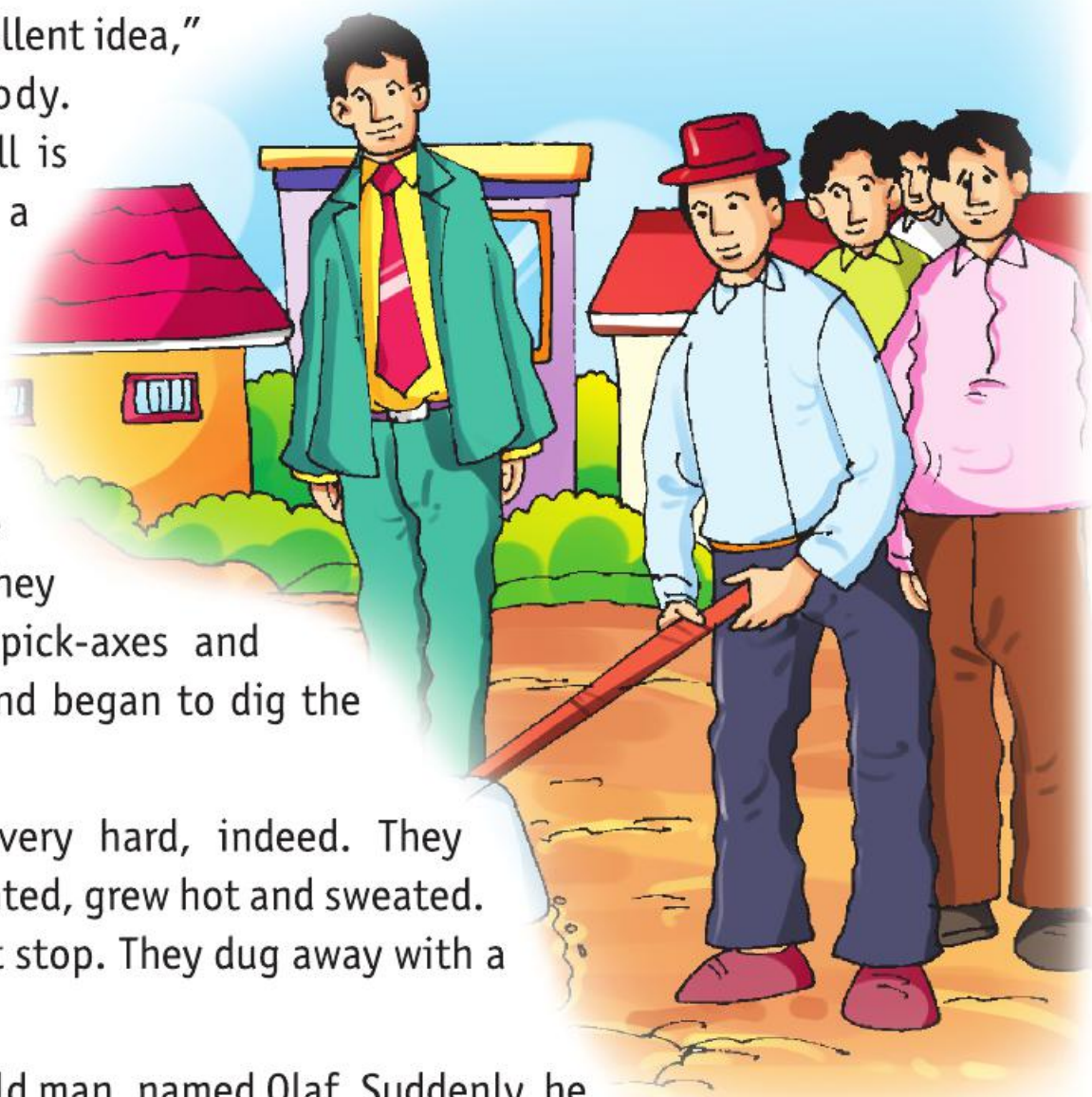
The others praised him and thumped him on the back. Then, they all got their pick-axes and their spades and began to dig the well.

They worked very hard, indeed. They puffed and panted, grew hot and sweated. But they didn't stop. They dug away with a will.

There was an old man, named Olaf. Suddenly, he stopped digging and held up his hand.

"Ho, ho!" He exclaimed. "There is another problem."

The others were surprised. All of them stopped to listen to him.



"We have dug out a lot of soil," said Olaf, "what are we going to do with the soil? We can't let it lie about. It will make our village look untidy."

"You're right," agreed everybody. "What should we do now?"

"Let's think again," suggested another man named Hans.

So, once again, they all sat in a circle to think. They thought and thought and after a long while, a man named Eric spoke. First, he cleared his throat and then he coughed and then he said, "We have already dug one hole. Let's dig another hole and put all the soil into the second one! Putting it back is the best thing to do."

"What a good idea!" Shouted the others in joy. "Why didn't we think of it before?"

Now again, they all set to work to dig the second hole. They worked harder than ever, and the hole got bigger and deeper.

And then suddenly

"STOP!" shouted one of the men, whose name was Sigmund.

Once again they all stopped their work and looked at him. Sigmund looked serious. He leaned on his spade.

"My friends," he said, "we have dug a beautiful hole but what we are going to do with all the soil we are digging out here?"

Nobody had any answer to this question. So for a long time, there was complete silence. They looked at Sigmund in dismay. Then they all sat again in a circle to think over the new problem. They rubbed their chins and scratched their heads and looked at one another's face.

Suddenly, Fritz, the wisest of them, called out, "I've got it!"

"Got what?" Cried everyone in great excitement.

"The answer to this new problem," Fritz smiled.

"Listen," he continued, "we'll dig another hole, a very big one, a hole so big that we can put the soil from both the holes in it!"



“Good, good,” Cried all the wise men of Mols.”

“Marvellous!” said one.

“Excellent” supported another.

So they got their spades out and began to dig a very big hole where they could put the soil of both the holes.

Perhaps, they are still digging out there in the Island of Mols. If you have any doubt, you can go and check out.

New Words to Learn



island – a piece of land surrounded by water on all sides, residents – inhabitants, hard-working – laborious, funny – amusing, restless – impatient, solution – answer, nodded – moved up and down, excellent – admirable, praised – admired, thumped – strokes, puffed – breathed heavily, panted – gasped, pickaxes – a type of implement used to dig soil, exclaimed – yelled, untidy – chaotic, leaned – bent, dismay – disappointment, rubbed – wiped, scratched – scraped, excitement – enthusiasm, marvellous – wonderful, splendid – superb, perhaps – probably, doubt – disbelief.



ASSIGNMENT



Comprehension Skill

A. Multiple Choice Questions :

(Analytical Skills)

Tick (✓) the correct option :

1. This is an old story about the residents of the island of _____.

(i) Mols

(ii) Laksha Dweep

(iii) Srilanka

(iv) India

2. We need a _____ in the village.

(i) school

(ii) well

(iii) hospital

(iv) Market

3. The man who came out with the idea of digging a well was _____.

(i) Olaf

(ii) Sigmund

(iii) Fritz

(iv) none of the above

4. Olaf suddenly stopped _____ and held up his hand.

(i) digging

(ii) talking

(iii) laughing

(iv) dancing

B. Fill in the blanks :

(Experiential Learning)

1. _____ is a tiny island to the north of _____.

2. All the wise men of _____ held a meeting.

3. They _____ and _____, grew hot and sweated.

4. Once again they all _____ their work and looked at him.

5. Cried all the wise men of _____.

6. They are still digging out there in the _____ of Mols.

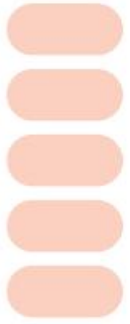
C. Write 'T' for true and 'F' for false :

(Critical Thinking)

1. Mols is a tiny island to the north of Denmark.

2. Digging a well is a very difficult job.

3. They puffed and panted, grew hot and sweated.
4. They did not stop to listen to anybody and continued digging.
5. Everybody laughed at Sigmund's question.
6. They decided to dig another big hole to put all the soil in it.
7. The residents of the island of Mols were very intelligent.



D. Answer the following questions :

(Writing Skills)

1. Where is the island of Mols? What did the residents of Mols love to do?

2. Why were the residents of Mols getting restless? What did they do?

3. Who came out with an idea? Did the others like it?

4. What problem did Olaf raise? Was it a genuine problem?

5. What was the suggestion of Eric? Did others act upon his suggestion?

6. What problem did Sigmund raise? Who came out with the solution?

Enhance Your Vocabulary

A. Look for the meanings of the following words in the dictionary and write them alongside :

(Critical Thinking)

1. island
2. solution
3. puff
4. lean
5. spade
6. excitement
7. crossly

B. Match the words in Column 'A' with their opposites in Column 'B' :

(Analyse)

'A'	'B'
1. Tiny 2. Wise 3. Funny 4. Problem 5. Restless 6. Excellent 7. Difficult	a. Serious b. Poor c. Relaxed d. Easy e. Solution f. Enormous g. Foolish

Let's Converse

- The residents of the island of the Mols decided to dig a well for their village. A well is dug to get potable (drinking) water. Look at the pictures below and write 'Yes' for the sources that provide us with potable water and 'No' for the sources that does not provide us with potable water.**

(Creative Thinking)

Y

N

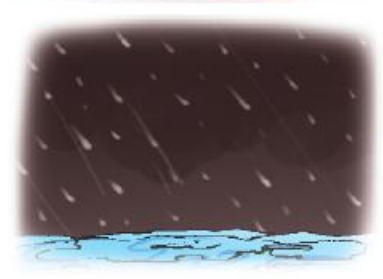














Enhance your Writing Skill

- Imagine that a resident of the island of Mols sent you a letter asking for suggestion on how they could get rid of the soil dug out in the process of digging the well. Write a note to be sent to him. (Writing Skills)

Check Your Language Skill

- **Use of Preposition**

Fill in the blanks choosing the correct preposition from the ones given below each sentence : (Analyse)

(Analyse)

1. The sun rises _____ the east and sets _____ the west.
(i) in (ii) at (iii) from
2. They are going _____ a picnic.
(i) for (ii) on (iii) in
3. The police was running _____ the thieves.
(i) behind (ii) after (iii) before
4. The bird is sitting _____ the tree.
(i) in (ii) over (iii) on
5. Mahatma Gandhi was born _____ Porbandar _____ Gujarat.
(i) in (ii) at (iii) on
6. The train was running _____ the river.
(i) in (ii) at (iii) on
7. The little boy dived _____ full speed.
(i) in (ii) into (iii) under
8. The thief jumped _____ the roof and fled.
(i) of (ii) from (iii) off
9. My brother killed a snake _____ stick
(i) by (ii) with (iii) of
10. We go to school _____ foot.
(i) by (ii) from (iii) on

Activity Time



A. An island is a piece of land in the sea or ocean surrounded by water from all sides. Discuss with your partner and try to define the following geographical terms. The first one is done for you. (Communication Skills)

(Communication Skills)

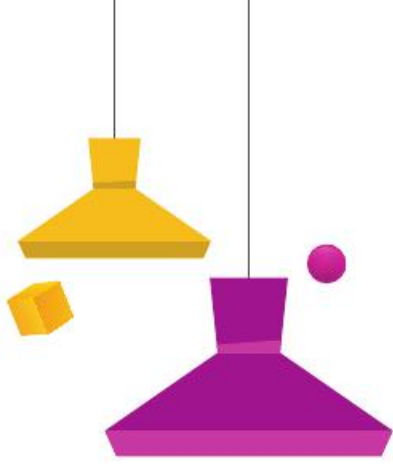
1. Strait : A narrow channel connecting two large bodies of water.

2. Hill : _____
3. Valley : _____
4. Bay : _____
5. Gulf : _____
6. Ocean : _____
7. Mountain : _____

B. Draw a picture of an island and colour it neatly :

(Art Integration)





4

Birbal Cooks the Rice

Emperor Akbar, the great Mughal emperor was illiterate. But he had a great respect for the scholars and intelligent men. He always patronized them and encouraged them to come and display their talents in the royal court. Nine wisest men of his time adorned his court. They were known as the 'Nine jewels' or 'Navratnas'. Akbar liked them very much. All of them were very dear to Emperor Akbar but amongst them all, Birbal was the most favourite one.

Birbal was very intelligent and possessed a sharp presence of mind. On many occasions, he had helped the Emperor solve many difficult problems. He always guided the Emperor in the right direction. As such, Akbar loved him too much. Though many of the courtiers were jealous of Birbal, they could never outwit him. Many stories are told about Birbal's wit and intelligence. Here is one of them.

One day, Emperor Akbar was sitting in his court. The court was full. All the courtiers including the Nine Jewels were present. Akbar was discussing about the nature of human-beings.

"I think a man can do anything to become rich." Birbal said to the Emperor. But the Emperor was not ready to agree.

"I don't think so." He said, "Can a man keep standing all night in the cold water of my palace pool just for the sake of money?" He asked Birbal.

"Yes he can, Your Majesty!" Birbal said. All the courtiers laughed at Birbal.

"Your Majesty! I will surely find such a man," Birbal was firm in his opinion.

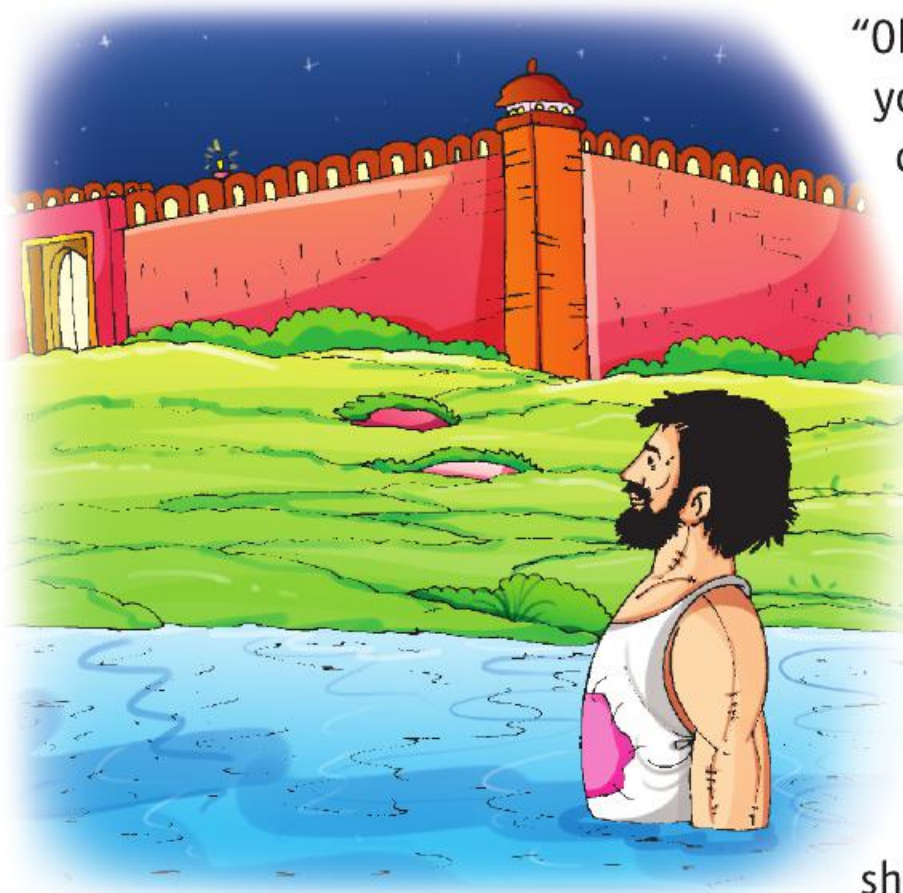
Soon Birbal came to know of a poor washerman. He was very poor and his family were almost on the edge of starvation. Birbal knew that the man was badly in need of money.

He met the poor washerman and asked him if could spend a night in the cold lake water to get a handsome reward from the Emperor. The washerman agreed at once.

The next day, Birbal brought the man to the Emperor.

"Are you ready to stand whole night in the cold water?" The Emperor asked the man.

"Yes, Your Majesty!" The man said, "But can I get a good reward if I survive?" He politely asked.



"Oh yes!" The Emperor said, "If you can spend the night in the cold water, you will get a handsome reward."

So, all through the night, the poor man kept on standing in the cold water of the lake. He was shivering in the cold but the hope of reward kept him alive. In the morning, when he came out of the lake and stood before the Emperor, he was still shivering.

"How could you stand in such cold water?" Asked the Emperor.

"My Lord!" Replied the poor man, "I kept my eyes fixed on the lamp burning on the roof of your palace and thus could stand the bitter cold."

"Ah"! Exclaimed one of the courtiers, "He has broken the rule by getting warmth from that light. He should not be given any reward."

"Yes! You have broken the rule; I cannot give you any reward." The Emperor said.

The poor washerman was sad. He left the palace with a broken heart. When he had gone only a little distance, he met Birbal. He told everything to him and begged for his help.

"Don't worry! You would surely get your reward." Birbal assured the poor man and went away.

The next morning, Birbal did not come to the court. He fixed three long poles on the ground, and put a pot full of rice and water on them. Then he lit a fire on the ground just beneath the pot and sat quietly.

When the Emperor didn't see Birbal in the court, he asked his attendants to go and call him. They went to Birbal's house but soon returned with Birbal's message that he would come after his meal is ready.

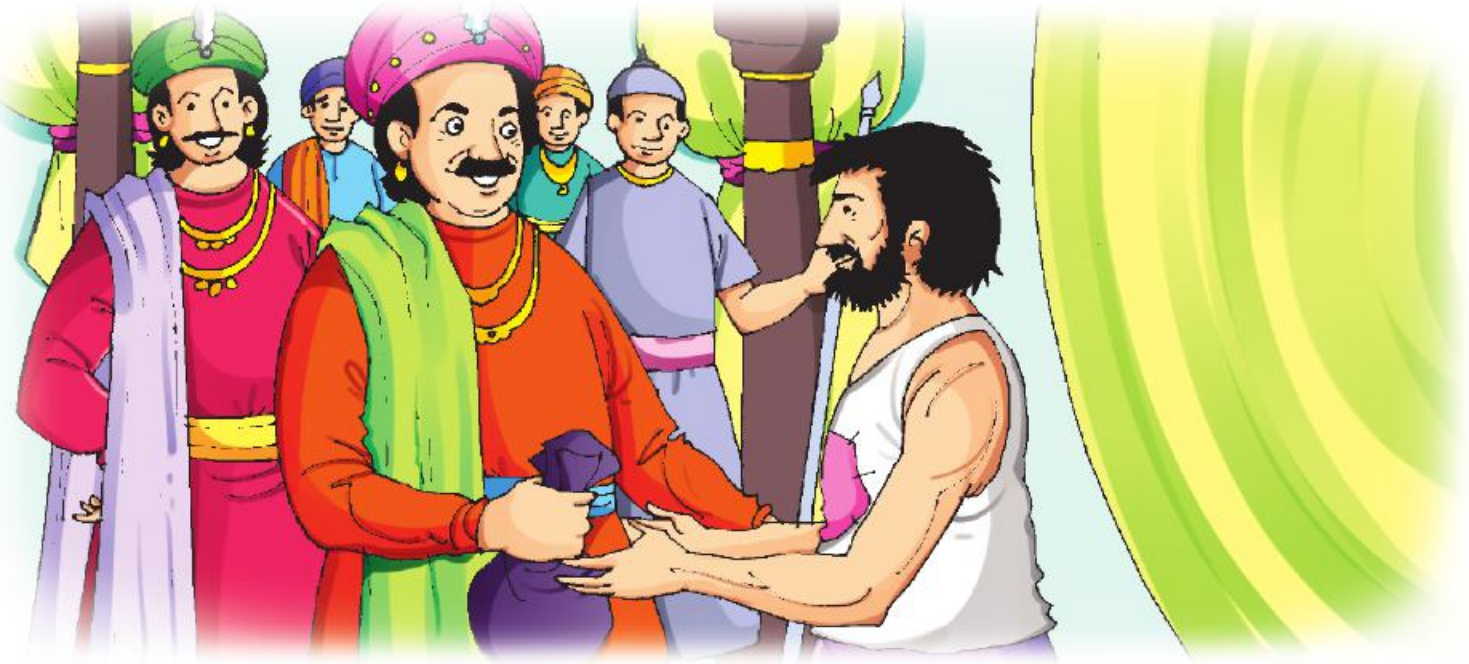
The Emperor became irritated. He sat on his elephant and left for the place where Birbal was busy cooking his food. The courtiers and the attendants followed behind. When the Emperor and his retinue reached there, Birbal was still sitting there waiting for the rice to boil.



“Birbal! What are you doing here?” He asked Birbal.

“Your Majesty! I am cooking rice,” Birbal replied calmly.

“Are you mad”, said Akbar, “Do you think that your far below fire can warm your far above cooking pot?”



“Your Majesty! If light on the roof of the palace can give warmth to a man standing in the cold water lake before your palace, then my fire will also surely cook the rice for me,” Birbal was as calm as before.

On hearing Birbal's words, Akbar at once realised what Birbal was trying to say. He asked his men to search for the poor man. He gave him a handsome reward and said laughing, “Today, Birbal has saved me from doing injustice.”

New Words to Learn



emperor – the ruler of an empire, illiterate – uneducated, scholars – intellectuals, patronized – supported, display – show, adorned – decorated, possessed – owned, jealous – envious, outwit – outsmart, laughed at – made fun of, starvation – hunger, spend – pass, handsome – attractive, reward – prize, survive – endure, shivering – trembling with cold, bitter – extreme, warmth – heat, with a broken heart – disappoint, assured – consoled, beneath – under, quietly – calmly, irritated – annoyed, retinue – entourage, realized; felt, injustice – prejudice, bowed – saluted.



ASSIGNMENT



Comprehension Skill

A. Multiple Choice Questions :

(Analytical Skills)

Tick (✓) the correct option :

- _____ wisest men of his time adorned his court.
(i) eight ☐ (ii) nine ☐
(iii) ten ☐ (iv) seven ☐
- He always _____ the Emperor in the right direction.
(i) guided ☐ (ii) helped ☐
(iii) cooperated ☐ (iv) poor ☐
- Akbar was discussing about the nature of _____.
(i) animals ☐ (ii) birds ☐
(iii) human beings ☐ (iv) crowed ☐
- Birbal knew that the man was badly in need of _____.
(i) food ☐ (ii) help ☐
(iii) money ☐ (iv) clothes ☐

B. Fill in the blanks :

(Experiential Learning)

- They were known as the _____ jewels' or _____.
- Many stories are told about _____ wit and _____.
- All the courtiers laughed at _____.
- The emperor became _____.
- _____ was as calm as before.

C. Write 'T' for true and 'F' for false :

(Critical Thinking)

- Emperor Akbar, the great Mughal Emperor was a great scholar. ☐
- Birbal was very intelligent and possessed a sharp presence of mind. ☐
- The washerman and his family were almost on the edge of starvation. ☐

4. The poor washerman didn't agree to spend one night in the cold water.
5. Birbal cooked a delicious food at his home.

D. Answer the following questions :

(Writing Skills)

1. Who was Birbal? Why did Emperor Akbar like him so much?

2. Why were many courtiers jealous of Birbal?

3. What was the discussion going on in the royal court?

4. What was Birbal's opinion? Did the Emperor agree with him?

5. How did the poor washerman spend the night in the cold water of the lake?

Enhance Your Vocabulary

A. Look for the meanings of the following words in the dictionary and write them alongside :

(Critical Thinking)

- | | |
|----------------------|---------------------|
| 1. intelligent _____ | 2. patronized _____ |
| 3. talents _____ | 4. guided _____ |
| 5. jealous _____ | 6. firm _____ |

B. Match the words in Column 'A' with their opposites in Column 'B' :

(Analyse)

'A'	'B'
1. Illiterate	a. Conceal
2. Display	b. Composed
3. Sharp	c. Literate
4. Reward	d. Above
5. Shivering	e. Punishment
6. Warmth	f. Blunt
7. Beneath	g. Cold

Let's Converse

- You have learnt that when the Emperor didn't see Birbal in the court, he asked his attendants to go and call him. They went to Birbal's house but Birbal send them back with the message that he would come after his meal is ready. At this, the Emperor became irritated and went himself to the place where Birbal was busy cooking his food. Imagine that you had also accompanied the Emperor. Now, complete the imaginary conversation that might have taken place between the Emperor and Birbal :** (Communication Skills)

Emperor : What's the matter Birbal? Why are you sitting here?

Birbal : Your Majesty! _____

Emperor : But do you think _____? Your pot is so high while _____

Birbal : Yes, Your Majesty! _____

Emperor : But how _____? Have you gone mad? Your food will never be cooked because _____ and the fire is so low. How can it cook your meal?

Birbal : But Your Majesty! the light on your _____ Even then the poor washerman felt its warmth standing _____.

Emperor : Birbal, what do _____?

Birbal : It's so simple Your Majesty! If the washerman _____

Emperor : Oh Birbal! Now, I have _____ It's really impossible to _____ at such a distant place.

Birbal : Yes, Your Majesty, this is what I mean to say.

Emperor : Birbal, you are a genius. You have _____ and saved me from doing injustice to _____. I am ordering my men _____ and I shall give him the reward he deserves.

Birbal : You are great. Your Majesty.

- Emperor** : Birbal, I am proud of you. Please stop me always whenever I do any injustice to anyone.
- Birbal** : It's my honour Your Majesty.

Enhance Your Writing Skill

- Emperor Akbar was great. Although he himself was illiterate, he had a great respect for the scholars and intelligent men. He always patronized them and encouraged them to come and display their talents in the royal court. What quality of Emperor is revealed in the above lines?** (Writing Skills)

Write your observation in a few sentences. You may start as follows :

Emperor Akbar was really great. He is famous for his love and respect for the scholarly people. He had nine wise men in his court who were called the

Check Your Language Skill

- Phrasal Verb**

A Phrasal Verb is a combination of a verb and an adverb or preposition. When an adverb or a preposition is added to a verb, the meaning of the verb is changed altogether.

Study the following examples :

I cannot make out the meaning of this sentence.

She is yet to make up her mind about her participation in the competition.

In the above examples, the verb 'make' has been used with 'out' and the meaning is 'to understand'. In the second sentence, meaning of the Phrasal Verb 'make up' is 'to decide'.

Fill in the blanks with correct Phrasal Verbs from the box given below. You may take the help of a dictionary.

(Analyse)

carry out	bear with	set out	call in	put out
give up	look after	look into	set up	belong to

1. Early in the morning, the tourists _____ to visit Agra.
2. She will never _____ such an insult.
3. You should never _____ your hope.
4. The fire brigade was called to _____ the fire.
5. The patient is not feeling well; we need to _____ a doctor.
6. Who will _____ the orphan child?
7. They have _____ a small business.
8. A player should _____ the instructions of his coach.
9. This umbrella _____ my mother.
10. The teacher has assured to _____ the matter.

Activity Time



- A. Birbal was cooking rice for him. Rice is the main food for the people of many eastern states of our country. Almost every states of our country have their favourite dishes; may be in the form of vegetables, fast food or sweets.**

Given below are the names of some food. Can you match the state to the food is particularly popular?

(Creative Thinking)

Name of Food

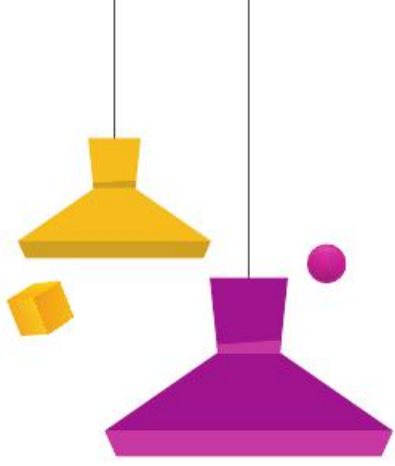
1. Srikhand
2. Biryani
3. Pao Bhaji
4. Rasgolla
5. Dosa

Name of state

- a. Hyderabad
- b. Tamil Nadu
- c. Gujrat
- d. Mumbai
- e. West Bengal

- B. Do you think that Birbal used a very intelligent way to make the emperor aware of his mistake. Work in groups and discuss in the class.**

(Communication Skills)



5

Alice in Wonderland

Alice was a little girl. She had one elder sister. One day, Alice was lying under a tree in the garden; her sister was reading a story book. It was a hot day and Alice was feeling drowsy. Soon she fell asleep.

Suddenly, in her dream, she saw a white rabbit passed by there. The rabbit had pink eyes. Alice had seen many rabbits but it was quite different from the others. It was wearing a waistcoat.

The rabbit took out a pocket-watch from the waistcoat pocket and looked at it. "Oh dear! It is already late." It cried.

Alice thought that there was something very different about this rabbit. It could talk, it wore a coat and it carried a



watch. "A talking rabbit! A rabbit that wears a waistcoat! Alice was burning with curiosity.



As the rabbit moved by, Alice followed. Soon the rabbit started running and Alice was after it. It crossed a field and suddenly popped down a large rabbit-hole and Alice too, followed it into the hole.

The hole was like a well and Alice went down and down and down and down into it. While falling, Alice noticed that the walls of the well were lined with cupboards and bookshelves.

"Where am I?" Alice wondered, "How many miles have I fallen? I must be

getting somewhere near the centre of the earth; will I slip through the earth to the other side?" She thought.

Then suddenly, "Thump!" Alice landed on a heap of dry leaves. She looked around quickly and saw a long passage before her and the white rabbit was still there. Alice ran after it again but soon it turned a corner and Alice heard it say, "Oh my ears and whiskers! How late it's getting." Alice turned the corner but the white rabbit was nowhere to be seen.

Alice was now in a hall, which was lit up with a row of lamps hanging from the ceiling. There were doors and doors all around the hall, but all of them were locked.

Suddenly, she saw a small glass table at the centre of the hall. A small golden key was lying on the table. Alice tried to open the doors with it, but it didn't fit into any of them.

Then she saw a low curtain. There was a little door only about fifteen inches high behind it, Alice tried the little key and to her great delight, it fitted. Alice opened the door. There was a small passage not much larger than a rat-hole.

She knelt down and looked along the passage. She could see a beautiful garden outside. There were colourful flowers. There was also a fountain playing in the middle of the garden.



Alice longed to see the beautiful garden. But the door was too small; she couldn't even get her head through it.

"Oh! How I wish, I could become smaller!" She exclaimed loudly.

Alice went back to the table. This time, she saw a little bottle lying on it. 'Drink Me.' The label of the bottle could be read. At first, Alice tasted some liquid from the bottle and then she drank it all.

She had a strange feeling. She thought as if she were getting smaller; and indeed she was! Soon she became only ten inches tall. Now she could go through the little door into the beautiful garden.

But when she returned back to the table to collect the key, she couldn't reach it. She tried to climb up one of the legs of the table, but she slipped down. Alice sat down and started crying.

Suddenly, she saw a glass box lying under the table. She opened the box. There was a small cake in it. The label on it read, 'Eat Me'. Alice ate the whole of the cake; it was so delicious!

After eating the cake, she was getting bigger and bigger. Soon she became big enough and her head struck against the table-top. She cried out in pain.

As she cried, her sister asked anxiously, "What's the matter Alice? Why are you crying?" As Alice opened her eyes, she found herself sitting under the tree with her sister beside.

Adapted from Alice in Wonderland

New Words to Learn



adventure – exploration, elder – senior, drowsy – sleepy, waistcoat – a garment with or without sleeves, burning with curiosity – too much anxious, suddenly – unexpectedly, popped down – went down, large – very big, slip – fall, noticed – observed, thud – a dull loud noise, heap – pile, whiskers – moustache, row – line, ceiling – the inside top covering of a room, curtain – screen, delight – enjoyment, passage – pathway, fountain – artificial spring, liquid – fluid, strange – peculiar, delicious – tasty, enough – sufficient



ASSIGNMENT >>

Comprehension Skill

A. Multiple Choice Questions :

(Analytical Skills)

Tick (✓) the correct option :

1. The rabbit had _____ eyes.

(i) red

☐

(ii) black

☐

(iii) pink

☐

(iv) green

☐

2. Alice was burning with _____ .

(i) hope

(ii) curiosity

(iii) desire

(iv) kind

3. Alice landed on a _____ of dry leaves.

(i) heap

(ii) bunch

(iii) pile

(iv) leather

4. Alice tried the little key and to her great _____ , it fitted.

(i) surprise

(ii) delight

(iii) amazement

(iv) none of the above

B. Fill in the blanks :

(Experiential Learning)

1. She had one _____ .

2. Alice had seen many _____ but it was _____ different.

3. Soon the rabbit started _____ and _____ was after it.

4. Oh my _____ and _____ !

5. There was also a fountain playing in the _____ of the _____ .

6. Alice sat down and started _____ .

C. Write 'T' for true and 'F' for false :

(Critical Thinking)

1. Alice was lying under a tree in the park.

2. The rabbit took out a pocket watch from the waistcoat pocket and looked at it.

3. The rabbit was wearing a waistcoat.

4. The hall was lit up with a row of lamps hanging from the ceiling.

5. A small silver key was lying on the table.

6. Alice drank the liquid from the bottle and regained her size.

7. Alice saw all these things in her dream.

D. Answer the following questions :

(Writing Skills)

1. Where was Alice lying one afternoon? What was her sister doing?

2. What did Alice see in her dream? What was the colour of its eyes?

3. What did the rabbit take out from its waistcoat pocket?

4. What were the walls of the hole lined with?

5. Where did Alice land on?

Enhance Your Vocabulary

- Look for the meanings of the following words in the dictionary and write them alongside : (Critical Thinking)

1. strange _____

2. drowsy _____

3. waistcoat _____

4. ceiling _____

5. delight _____

6. whiskers _____

7. delicious _____

Let's Converse

- Alice saw a rabbit in her dream. She followed it and reached the big hall where there were many doors but all were locked. She found a garden behind a closed door and wished to go there. But the door was locked and it was only fifteen inches high. Now, imagine that Alice met the rabbit and requested it to help her to go to the garden. Complete the following conversation that might have taken place between Alice and the rabbit. (Communication Skills)

Alice : What is this _____ called?

Rabbit : This place is called the wonderland.

Alice : I have seen a _____ behind one of the doors. I want to go there.

Rabbit : Why not, just open the lock of the door and you will reach there.

Alice : But where is _____ ?

Rabbit : It's lying _____ the centre of the hall.

Alice : Thank you, but the _____.

Rabbit : There is a _____ if you drink it, you will become short.

Alice : But how will I _____ again?

Rabbit : There is a _____ if you eat the cake, you will regain your old size.

Alice : Very nice, will you also _____?

Rabbit : No, I am already late, so I _____.

Alice : O.K. then. Let me _____.

Enhance Your Writing Skill

- Alice saw some strange and interesting things in her dreams. In her dream, she saw a rabbit wearing a waistcoat. It had a pocket watch and it was always in a hurry. She followed the rabbit and reached in a strange land where she experienced many new things. Now, imagine that you are Alice. Write a few lines describing the things you saw and did there in the wonderland. You may start as follows : (Writing Skills)

I was sitting with my sister under the shade of a tree. It was very hot and I felt drowsy. Suddenly I saw a rabbit _____

Check your language skill

- Use of Contractions**

Look at the following sentences :

I **don't** want to go to the zoo.

They're waiting for the bus.

Sometimes, we use shortened forms of expressions. They are called **Contractions**. In Contractions an apostrophe (') is used to replace the missing letter or letters.

A. Rewrite the following sentences by replacing the underlined words with suitable contractions. You may take help from the box given below : (Phonics Skills)

I've are 'nt didn't haven't It's hasn't you're we've

1. You are writing a letter. _____
2. It is not the proper way to talk to your elder. _____
3. I have told you the truth. _____
4. We have played the match. _____
5. They are not coming today. _____
6. The poor boy has not eaten anything since morning. _____
7. She has not seen the movie. _____
8. The train has not left the station. _____
9. You have not done your homework. _____
10. The little girl has not plucked flowers. _____

B. Fill in the blanks with 'some' or 'any' : (Analyse)

1. Are there _____ students in the class?
2. I have _____ important news to tell you.
3. There were _____ beautiful paintings in the exhibition.
4. Did he take _____ book from you?
5. Has she given you _____ purse?
6. I have _____ oranges for you.
7. Did you take _____ medicine for your illness?
8. Does he have _____ sugar new cricket bat?
9. I need _____ in my tea.
10. Did you buy _____ thing in the fair?

Activity Time



- A. In the story, you have read about the dream Alice had. You must have enjoyed her dream. It was interesting to know how she reached the wonderland, noticed the strange things, enjoyed the things she drank and ate and the results of the same. Now, can you write down from your memory any five strange things or places or happenings that Alice saw/felt in her dream?

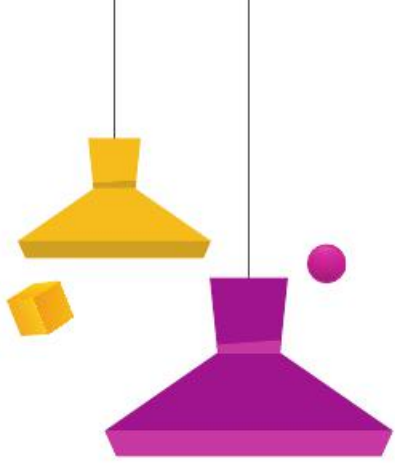
1. _____
3. _____
5. _____

2. _____
4. _____

- B. 'Alice in Wonderland' is a very popular book written by Lewis Carroll. His full name was Charles Ludvig Dog son. Go to the library and read some more books written by the same author. Also collect their pictures and paste them in your scrapbook.

- C. Draw the picture of the rabbit as per the description you have read in the lesson and colour it also :

(Art Integration)



6

A Journey to Neverland

Peter was a boy who never grew up, for he had run away to live in Neverland when he was very young. Neverland is an island that children visit in their dreams. It is a land where anything can happen.

If you want to reach there, you have to be able to fly. Peter could fly, so he reached there easily.

Sometimes, when he felt lonely, he would go back to the human world. He would listen to the bed time stories, mothers told their children. And as the children went to sleep, they would dream about Neverland.

If you could have looked into their minds, you would have seen a picture-map of the island, streaked with beautiful colours. There was a lake and a pirate-ship in the island. There was a dense forest full of wild animals and there were houses made of upside-down boats and wigwams and caves.





One night, when Peter was on a visit to the human world, he decided to take back some playmates with him. He entered into a house through the bedroom window. There were three children on bed. They were fast asleep and they were all dreaming about Neverland. Peter woke them up.

"Come with me to Neverland." He said, "It'll be a great adventure for you."

"But we can't fly," said they.

"Don't worry! I'll teach you." Peter said, "Just wriggle your shoulders and let go."

He swooped around the room, and one by one they followed him. At the beginning, they felt a bit wobbly-- but soon they managed quite well.

"Now follow me," said Peter. "We'd go out through the window. Turn right and fly till morning."

At first, it was great fun. They raced among the clouds and stars. But after sometime, they began feeling cold and tired. They wished they were back in their cosy beds.

They were hungry, too. Peter stole food for them from the passing birds, but that was not like the breakfast they eat at home.

Now, they had to fly over the sea. It was very dangerous, for if they fell asleep, they would drop like ripe fruits and fall into the waves.



At last, they saw Neverland below. It was just as they had imagined in their dreams.

"Let's land here," said the children.

"But they won't let us!" Said Peter.

"Who won't?" They asked.

"The pirates. They're right below."

Then, Peter told them about the pirates and Hook, their cruel leader.

"I cut off his right hand!" He said proudly.

"Then he can't fight?" The children were "Oh yes, he can. He has an iron hook instead of a hand, and he uses it as a claw." Peter replied.

The pirates, too, had seen the children. They loaded their big gun and got ready to shoot. Suddenly, there was a loud bang! Their gun had been fired. The blast blew the children onto their backs and scattered them. When they got together again, Peter flew them to a safer place where they landed safely.

Then, he led them into his underground home. It was an enormous cave in the woods, hollowed out under the roots of seven tall trees. Each trunk had a hole in it just big enough for a child to wriggle into. These were the doors into the cave.

The children felt comfortable in the house. They sawed off a Nevertree that grew in the middle and used it as a table. They fixed hammocks for beds and lived there for a few weeks. They ate island food– bananas, large pineapples, and all kinds of berries. It was really exciting! And Peter never forgot to take them on a new adventure everyday.

(Adapted and slightly abridged from Peter Pan by J.M. Berrie)

New Words to Learn



lonely – alone, streaked – patterned, pirates – sea robbers, wigwams – tent or hut used by American Indians, playmates – friends, adventures – exciting activities, wriggle – move about, swooped – flew around, wobbly – unstable, imagined – dreamt of, pirates – robbers of the sea, curious – inquisitive, claw – scrape, bang – loud sound made by guns etc., scattered – strewn, safely – unharmed, enormous – very large, comfortable – relaxing, sawed – cut, hammocks – beds made of canvas or rope network, exciting – thrilling



ASSIGNMENT >>

Comprehension Skill

A. Multiple Choice Questions :

(Analytical Skills)

Tick (✓) the correct option :

- An island that children visit in their dreams was _____.
(i) Neverland ☐ (ii) Dreamland ☐
(iii) Disneyland ☐ (iv) none of the above ☐
- Peter could _____, so he reached there easily.
(i) swim ☐ (ii) fly ☐
(iii) run ☐ (iv) walk ☐
- There was a lake and a _____-ship in the island.
(i) wooden ☐ (ii) large ☐
(iii) pirate ☐ (iv) small ☐
- One night, when Peter was on a visit to the human world, he decided to take back some _____ with him.
(i) playmates ☐ (ii) toys ☐
(iii) food ☐ (iv) clothes ☐

B. Fill in the blanks :

(Experiential Learning)

- it is a land where anything can _____.
- There was a lake and a _____ in the _____.
- They raced among the _____ and _____.
- Peter told them about the and Hook, there cruel _____.
- The children felt _____ in the house.
- It was really _____ !

C. Write 'T' for true and 'F' for false :

(Critical Thinking)

- Neverland is a land where anything can happen. ☐
- Peter could swim, so he reached there easily. ☐

3. He entered into a house through the open door.
5. The blast blew the children onto their backs and scattered them.
6. Then he led them into his underground home.



D. Answer the following questions :

(Writing Skills)

1. Why did Peter Pan never grow up?

2. What was the island like?

3. Who taught the three children to fly?

4. What did the pirates do when they saw the children?

5. How did Peter arrange food for the children?

Enhance Your Vocabulary

- **Look for the meanings of the following words in the dictionary and write them alongside :**

(Critical Thinking)

1. island _____

2. wriggle _____

3. curious _____

4. claw _____

5. enormous _____

6. sawed _____

Let's Converse

- **You have just read the story of Peter Pan and his adventures. Now, discuss in groups and answer the following questions based on the story :**

(Communication Skills)

1. Peter never grew up because.

(i) He believed in dreaming more than reality.

(ii) He was not eating his food regularly.

(iii) He had a disease which prevented him from growing.

Ans : _____

2. Why is the island that children visit in their dreams called as Neverland?

- (i) Anything can happen in the island they visit.
- (ii) The island never exists in reality.
- (iii) Children could only dream to reach there but not in real life.

Ans : _____

3. How would you describe an island?

- (i) piece of land completely surrounded by water.
- (ii) land of ice surrounded by forest.
- (iii) garden full of palm trees and rose plants.

Ans : _____

4. The children raced among the clouds and stars. But after some time, they began feeling cold and tired. They wished they were back in their cozy beds. What did they do then?

- (i) They went back home and slept in their cozy beds.
- (ii) They continued to fly over the sea and finally reached the Neverland.
- (iii) They fell asleep, dropped down in the sea and were drowned.

Ans : _____

5. Peter said proudly that he had cut off the hand of the leader of the pirates. What was the name of the leader?

- (i) Hook
- (ii) Crook
- (iii) Book

Ans : _____

6. The pirates fired at the children and the blast blew the children onto their backs and scattered them. What happened then?

- (i) They landed in different places and lost their way.
- (ii) When they gathered, Peter flew them to a safer place.
- (iii) The children were afraid but they were safe.

Ans : _____

Enhance Your Writing Skill

- **Peter started his journey of adventure with his three playmates to reach the island of Neverland. Now, write in a few simple sentences in your own words how they reached the underground home in Neverland.** (Writing Skills)

Check Your Language Skill

- **One Word Substitution**

Sometimes, the meaning of a group of words can be expressed by using only one single word. Such words are called 'One Word Substitution.'

Look at the following sentences :

She had to get her shoes mended; therefore, she went to the person who repairs shoes.

The above sentence can be written as under :

She had to get her shoes mended; therefore, she went to the cobbler.

Here the word 'cobbler' has been used as 'One Word Substitution' for the expression 'the person who repairs shoes.'

Now, rewrite the following sentences using 'One Word' for the italicized portions : (Analyse)

1. I bought some vegetables from the person who sells green vegetables.

2. I met a person who cannot read or write.

3. The water tap in the lawn is leaking; please call the person who repairs taps, sanitary fittings etc.

4. I visited the shop selling pens, pencils, notebooks etc. and bought some stationery.

5. Please call a person who makes tables, chairs etc. to repair my old table.

Activity Time



• **You have read in this story about Peter and his Neverland :** (Creative Thinking)

1. What would be the place you would like to visit in your dream? It need not be a Neverland which never exists. You can write any name of a city or a country where you want to visit.

Ans : _____

2. How would you reach the place of your dream? By flying like Peter with his playmates or you will travel by train, car, bus or aeroplane?

Ans : _____

3. While travelling, by aeroplane, train or boat, how and where would you get food if you feel hungry :

Aeroplane : _____

Train : _____

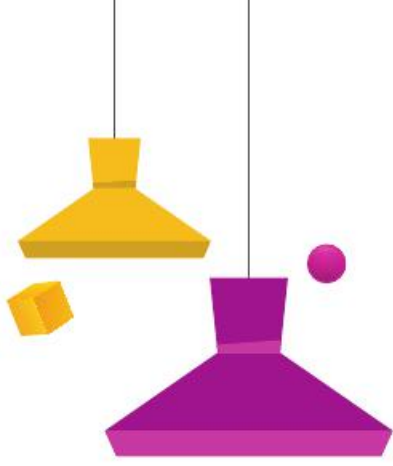
Boat : _____

4. Suppose you reach a wonderland in your dream, what are the things you would like to see there, e.g. garden, temple, sea, ships etc. Describe whatever you want to see.

Ans : _____

5. Would you like to dream everyday and share it with your friends? Would you like to exchange your views with them?

Ans : _____



7

The Wind

I saw you toss the kites on high
And blow the birds about the sky;
And all around I heard you pass,
Like ladies' skirts across the grass
O wind, a-blowing all day long!
O wind, that sings so loud a song!
I saw the different things you did,
But always you yourself you hid.
I felt you push, I heard you call,
I could not see yourself at all...
O wind, a-blowing all day long!
O wind, that sings so loud a song!
O you that are so strong and cold,
O blower, are you young or old?
Are you a beast of field and tree,
Or just a stronger child than me?



O wind, a-blowing all day long!
O wind, that sings so loud a song!

Robert Louis Stevenson

New Words to Learn



toss – throw up, a-blowing – moving, hid – concealed, loud – shrill, beast – animal, stronger – more powerful



ASSIGNMENT »

Comprehension Skill

A. Multiple Choice Questions :

Tick (✓) the correct option :

1. Blow the birds about the .

(i) earth

☐

(ii) sky

☐

(iii) stars

☐

(iv) moon

☐

2. O wind, that sings so loud a .

(i) song

☐

(ii) rush

☐

(iii) crowed

☐

(iv) none of the above

☐

B. Complete the following lines :

1. I saw you _____

_____ about the sky

And all round _____

_____ the grass.

2. O you that _____

_____ or old?

Are you a _____ ,

_____ child than me?

C. Write 'T' for true and 'F' for false :

1. The wind keeps on blowing all day long.
2. We can see the wind blowing.
3. We can only feel the passing wind.
4. The wind is like an untamed wild beast.
5. The wind sings a loud song while blowing.



D. Answer the following questions :

1. What does the wind do to the kite?

2. How does the poet come to know of the passing wind?

3. Why couldn't the poet see the wind?

4. What does the wind do while blowing?

5. What is the poet confused about?

Enhance Your Vocabulary

A. Find out the words from the poem that rhyme with the words in column 'A' and write them in column 'B' :

Column 'A'
1. high
2. pass
3. long
4. call
5. cold

Column 'B'

B. Use the following words in sentences of your own so as to bring out their meanings :

1. Across : _____

2. Hid : _____
3. Wind : _____
4. Strong : _____
5. Beast : _____

C. Explain the meaning of the following lines :

I saw the different things you did but always you yourself you hid?

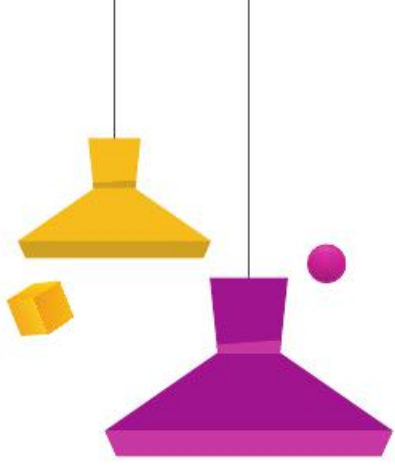
Activity Time



- **Draw any two pictures that are flying in the sky. Colour them and also write their name :**

Name

Name



8

Rain Cloud

Once upon a time there was an old fisherman Ye Myint and his wife Aye Aye Se. The old man and his wife did not have any children. They lived by the side of the river Irrawaddy. Every day, Ye Myint cast his net in the river and caught fish, which they sold at the local market.

One day while fishing as usual, Ye Myint cast his net and waited for the catch. When, after some time he pulled up his net, he was surprised to get only an egg. He recognized it as a crocodile egg.

He called out to his wife who picked up the egg, took it home and put it under some straw. Some days later the egg hatched and a small baby crocodile came out.

Ye Myint and Aye Aye Se were very happy. They called



the crocodile 'Rain Cloud' and treated him as their son. Every day, after they returned from fishing, the old man and his wife would call out to Rain Cloud and feed him the choicest fish from their catch. Ye Myint made a small enclosure of river water where Rain Cloud swam safe from any predators.

As the days went by, Rain Cloud grew and soon he was too big for the small pond that his father had made. So, with a heavy heart Ye Myint and Aye Aye Se put him back in the river.

But every day, without fail, both would go and call out to Rain Cloud to feed him. Soon Rain Cloud became very strong and all the fishes and other crocodiles became afraid of him. This made Rain Cloud very vain and proud. He no longer took Ye Myint and Aye Aye Se to be his parents but as ordinary human beings who came every day to feed him and pay homage.

One day, as Ye Myint called out to Rain Cloud, he slithered from the tall bull rushes and came to the bank of the river. He was in a bad and vicious mood.

As the fisherman put out the fish for him to eat, Rain Cloud went underwater and caught hold of his ankle, pulling him towards the water.

"My son what are you doing?" asked Ye Myint.

"I have decided to eat you today," said Rain Cloud with an angry hiss.

"But I am your father and I have always looked after you so much with love and care."

"I have to eat you nevertheless," said Rain Cloud, his eyes red with anger.

"Okay you can do that but let me pray for the last time," requested Ye Myint. Rain Cloud agreed and the old man fell on his knees, closed his eyes and with all his heart prayed that in his next birth he should be born as the Master of White Magic so that he could take revenge from the crocodile. For Rain Cloud had broken his trust.

After he had finished praying, Rain Cloud dragged the fisherman to the river and ate him up.

After that day, Rain Cloud became even more vicious and was greatly feared by animals, fish and human beings who fished by the river. He now was the King of Irrawady.

Many years passed and Rain Cloud was getting older. With the passage of time, he mellowed down. He started thinking about his past and felt remorseful at eating up the old man who had been a father to him. He would often think of him and feel very guilty. He was no longer vain and turned kind and helpful, especially towards human beings. He wanted to make up for what he had done.

Now, crocodiles can take on human forms after they are 100 years old. So, after Rain Cloud turned 100, he shed his scaly crocodile skin on the banks of Irrawady and walked out as a handsome young man.

He worked as an artist who excelled in painting landscape that brought out the incredible blues of the sky, the soaring birds or nesting cranes and the silver grey of the river. It was while painting, he met a beautiful young woman Soe Mein, fell in love with her and married her. Rain Cloud and Soe Mein lived an peaceful existence. They were very happy. Rain Cloud built a house not far from the Irrawady.

As fate would have it, a boy was born in a village close to the Irrawady. His name was Moe Kyaw. He was Ye Myint who had taken re-birth. He remembered the boon he had asked God for and by the time he was 16, became the Master of White Magic.

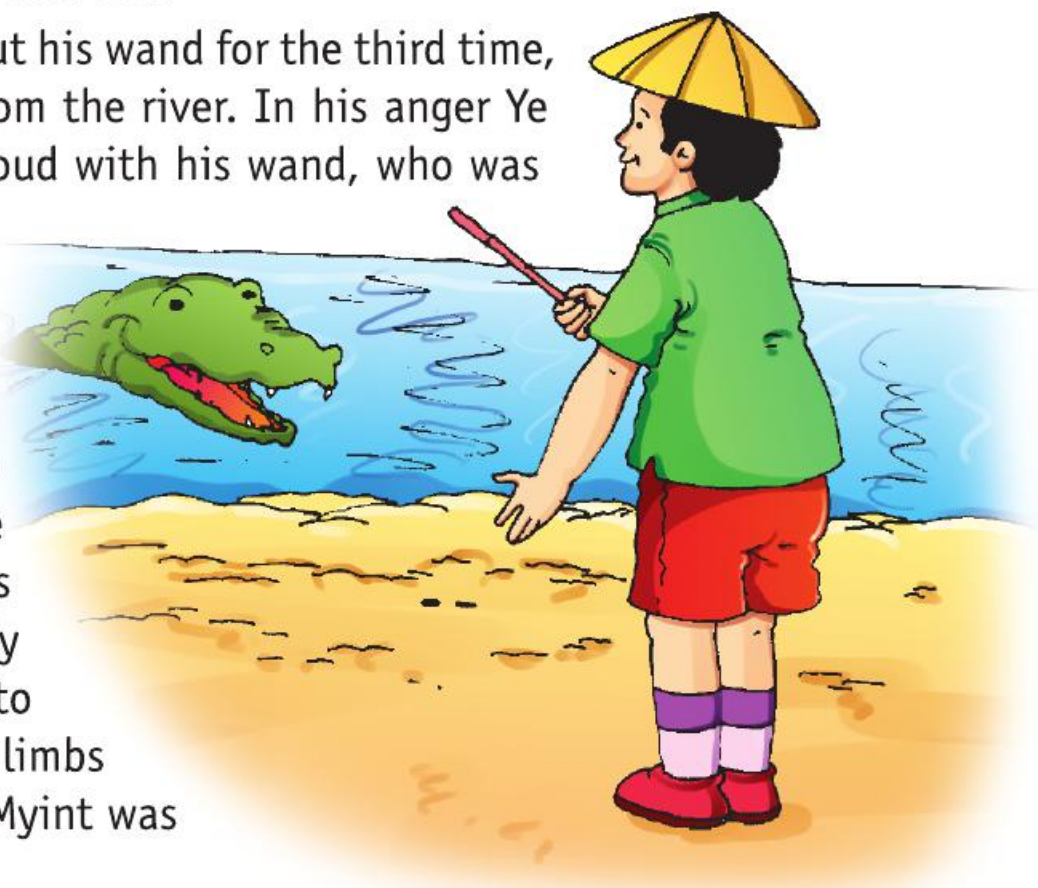
On his 17th birthday, Moe Kyaw went to the bank of the Irrawady, took out his magic wand and dipping it in water cried out loudly, "Rain Cloud!"

Rain Cloud, who was sleeping in his house, woke up with a start. He heard the rumble of the Master of White Magic and was panicked. He woke up his sleeping wife and told her his life's story. Soe Mein clung to him crying, she was afraid to lose him. "Be brave my dearest," Rain Cloud said as he was leaving, "I have to pay for what I have done." Rain Cloud hurried to the river and became a crocodile once again.

He hurried away as he heard the second call of the Master of White Magic. He recognised the voice of his father and knew that he had come to take revenge. With a heavy heart Rain Cloud knew that it was only with his death that the vicious cycle would end.

By the time Ye Myint put his wand for the third time, Rain Cloud came up from the river. In his anger Ye Myint touched Rain Cloud with his wand, who was killed instantly.

The Master of White Magic had not anticipated that Rain Cloud would leave something for him. He watched in surprise as Rain Cloud's upper body and two legs turned to rubies and his lower limbs became pure gold. Ye Myint was filled with remorse.



revenge, it was at the cost of the life of his son - Rain Cloud. He realised that revenge never pays anybody but leaves one with a heavy heart and years of regret to live with.

Ye Myint did not touch the riches that Rain Cloud offered him in his death and with one last sorrowful look he left.

Soe Mein came looking for her beloved Rain Cloud. When she came across his form in gold and rubies she cried knowing that Rain Cloud had died.

Soe Mein collected all the gold and rubies and built a big pagoda in the name of Rain Cloud which still remains on the banks of the silver gray river Irrawady where Rain Cloud had lived and died.

It is said that those who throng the pagoda get their heart's desire.

A folktale from Myanmar



cast – throw, recognized – identified, hatched – emerged, choicest – best, enclosure – area surrounded from all sides, predator – killer, vain – hopeless, homage – respect, slithered – glided, vicious – cruel, hiss – whisper, nevertheless – but, revenge – vengeance, dragged – pulled, mellowed – matured, remorseful – sorry, guilty – responsible, excelled – shined, incredible – unbelievable, existence – survival, boon – benefit, rumbled – roared, panicked – feared, clung – hugged, hurried – rushed, sorrowful – sad, throng – crowd



ASSIGNMENT



Comprehension Skill

A. Multiple Choice Questions :

(Analytical Skills)

Tick (✓) the correct option :

- He recognized it as a _____ egg.

(i) crocodile	☐	(ii) crow	☐
(iii) ostrich	☐	(iv) parrot	☐
- They called the crocodile _____ and treated him as their son.

(i) Rain Cloud	☐	(ii) Rainbow	☐
(iii) Dark Cloud	☐	(iv) none of the above	☐
- So, with a heavy heart Ye Myint and Aye Aye Se put him back him in the _____.

(i) sea	☐	(ii) river	☐
(iii) lake	☐	(iv) pond	☐
- This made Rain Cloud very vain and _____.

(i) weak	☐	(ii) vicious	☐
(iii) proud	☐	(iv) happy	☐
- Many years passed and Rain Cloud was getting _____.

(i) wiser	☐	(ii) weaker	☐
(iii) older	☐	(iv) small	☐

B. Fill in the blanks :**(Experiential Learning)**

1. They lived by the side of the river _____ .
2. Ye _____ and Any Any Se were very _____ .
3. This made rain cloud very _____ and _____ .
4. "Okay you can do that but let me _____ for the last time."
5. Rain cloud dragged the to the _____ river and ate him up.
6. Ye _____ was filled with remorse.

C. Write 'T' for true and 'F' for false :**(Critical Thinking)**

1. Ye Myint was an old farmer.
2. Some days later the egg hatched and a small baby snake came out.
3. Soon Rain Cloud became very strong and all the fishes and other crocodiles became afraid of him.
4. Ye Myint and Aye Aye Se put him back him in the ocean.
5. Rain Cloud and Soe Mein lived a peaceful existence.
6. Ye Myint took rebirth as the Mater of White Magic.
7. Ye Myint did not touch the riches that Rain Cloud offered him in his death.

D. Answer the following questions :**(Writing Skills)**

1. Where did the old man and his wife live?

2. Why did Ye Myint make a small enclosure of river water?

3. What made Rain Cloud vain and proud?

4. What was Ye Myint's request to Rain Cloud before being eaten?

5. What did Rain Cloud feel remorseful about?

Enhance Your Vocabulary

A. Look for the meanings of the following words in the dictionary and write them alongside : (Critical Thinking)

1. recognized _____
2. choicest _____
3. predator _____
4. homage _____
5. vicious _____
6. remorseful _____
7. clung _____

B. Match the words in Column 'A' with their opposites in Column 'B' : (Analyse)

'A'	'B'
1. Catch	a. Joyful
2. Afraid	b. Drop
3. Anger	c. Brave
4. Remorseful	d. Destroyed
5. Built	e. Calm
6. Peaceful	f. Unrepentant
7. Sorrowful	g. Disordered

Let's Converse

- Rain Cloud lived in the river Irrawady. Irrawady is a big river of Myanmar. Many big rivers flow in different countries. Discuss with your partner and find out the name of the country in which each of the following river flows :** (Creative Thinking)

Name of the River	Name of the country
1. Ganga	_____
2. Nile	_____
3. Sindhu	_____

- | | |
|-------------|-------|
| 4. Thames | _____ |
| 5. Danuybe | _____ |
| 6. Amazan | _____ |
| 7. Hwang Ho | _____ |

Enhance Your Writing Skill

- Have you ever seen a crocodile? Where did you see it? Where does a crocodile live? What does it eat? Does it attack human beings? Write a few lines describing a crocodile :** (Writing Skills)

Check Your Language Skill

- Ye Myint was a 'Master of White Magic'. He was a great magician. A magician is one who practices magic. What do we call the following? Take help from the help box :** (Analyse)

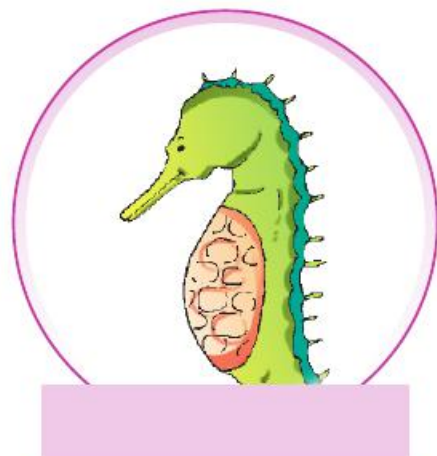
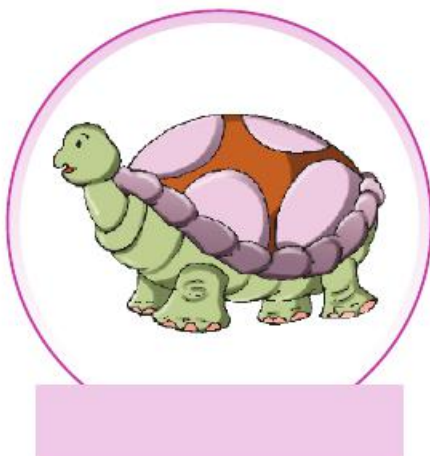
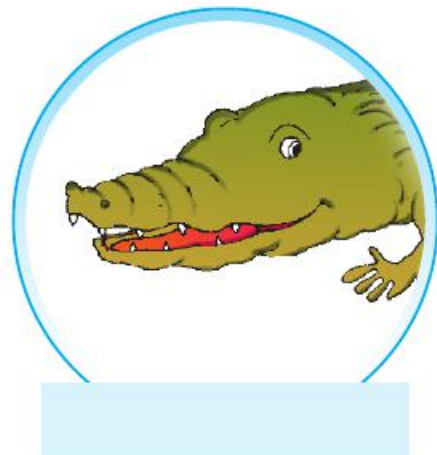
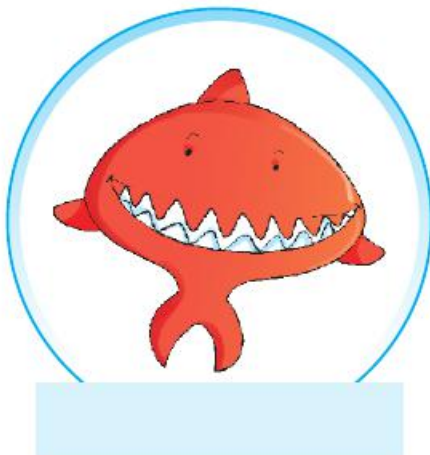
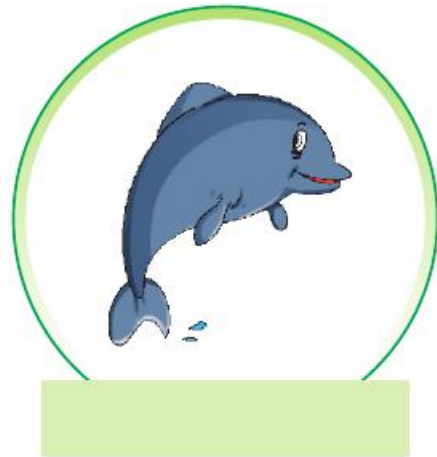
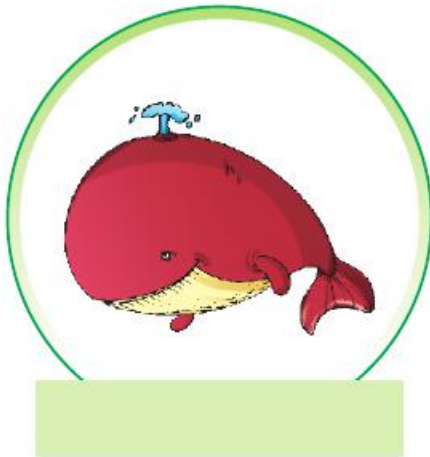
spendthrift pessimist cannibal illiterate martyr pilgrim optimist

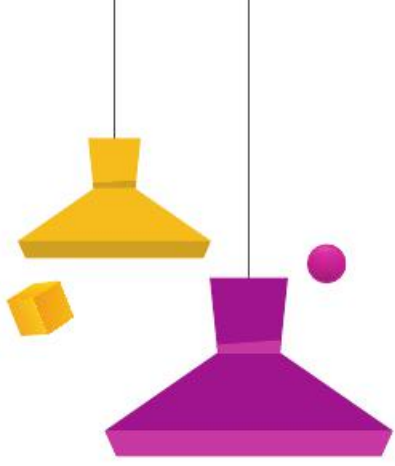
- | | |
|--|-------|
| 1. One who does not know how to read or write. | _____ |
| 2. One who goes on a journey to a holy place. | _____ |
| 3. One who looks at the dark side of things. | _____ |
| 4. One who looks at the bright side of things. | _____ |
| 5. One who spends money extravagantly. | _____ |
| 6. One who eats human flesh. | _____ |
| 7. One who sacrifices his life for his motherland. | _____ |

Activity Time



- Rain Cloud was a crocodile. A crocodile is an Aquatic animal that lives in big rivers. There are many other animals that live in water. Given below are the pictures of some animals that live in water. Look at the pictures, discuss with your partner and identify the animals : (Creative Thinking)





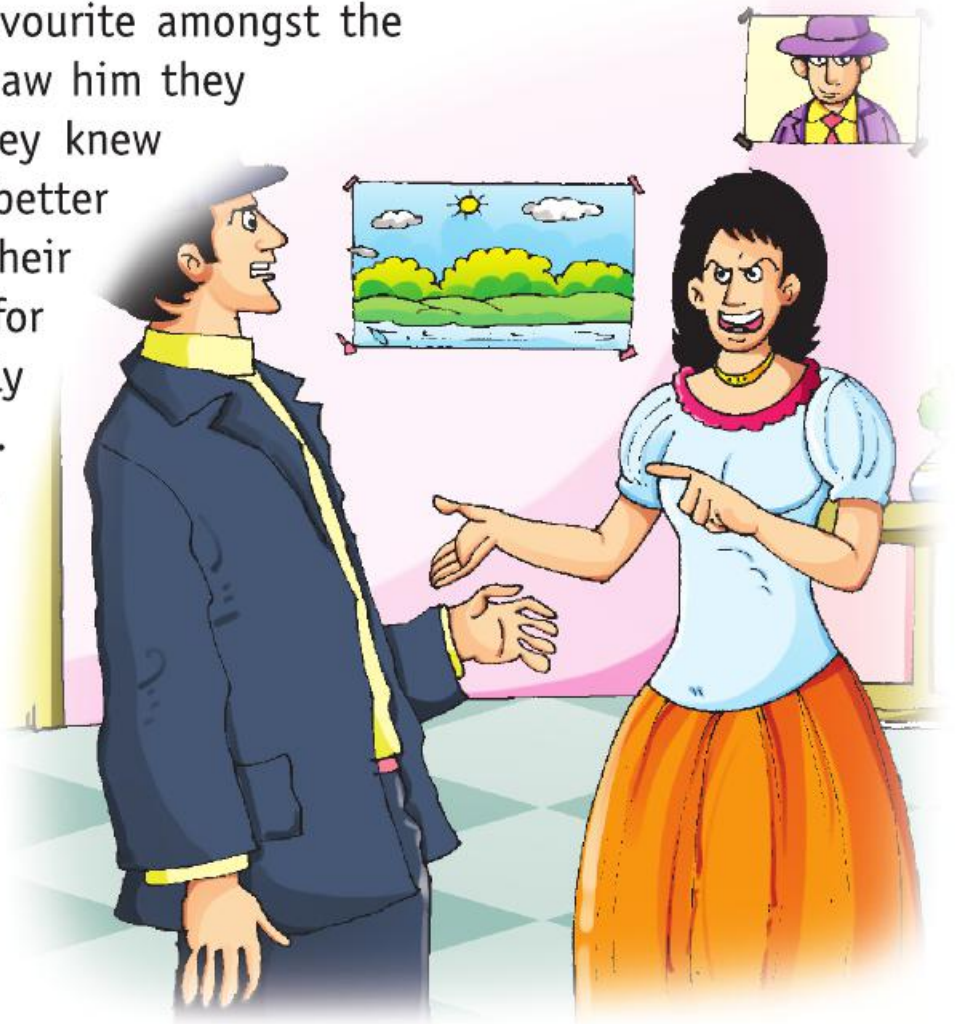
9

Rip Van Winkle-I

Long, long ago, there lived a man called Rip Van Winkle in a little village of America. He was kind and gentle and the people of the village liked him, because he was always willing to help them in their work.

However, he was much favourite amongst the children. Whenever they saw him they shouted with glee for they knew that he liked nothing better than taking part in their games. He made toys for them and taught them to fly kites and to play marbles. Often he would sit in the cool shade of a tree and tell them fine tales of witches and fairies.

The only thing Rip disliked was work. Rip hated hard work. He was somewhat lazy and did not like to do anything. For that



reason he was very poor and his wife and children were always hungry and ill-clad. His little farm too was badly kept; weeds grew all over it; the fences were broken down and his cows were always going astray.

Day after day his wife would scold her husband. "Idle, good-for-nothing fellow!" She would shout. "Why don't you do a little work on your farm, instead of sleeping or playing with the village children?" Not a word would Rip say in reply. Instead, he would go to the nearby woods and wait there until his wife's temper had cooled down.

One day, when everything had gone wrong his wife scolded Rip more than she had ever done before. This time Rip did not go to the village as usual. Taking his gun upon his shoulder and his faithful dog calling 'Wolf' to go with him, he set off to wander among the woods and hills.

Rip lay down on a grassy bank and stayed there till late in the afternoon. When the sun was about to set, Rip rose to go. "Come on 'Wolf'," he said to his dog. "Let us go home now. Perhaps her temper has cooled by this time, though I fear that she may have something to say to us for staying away so long."



They began to walk down the hill when suddenly a voice cried out, "Rip Van Winkle! "Rip Van Winkle!" Rip looked all around. At first he saw nothing but a crow; then he noticed, a long way off, a strange little man, with a keg upon his shoulders.

“Rip Van Winkle! Rip Van Winkle!” The voice called out again. Rip walked across the hillside until he came near the man. “Did you call me, Sir!” He asked in wonder. The man did not reply; instead, he made a sign, as if to say, “Please, carry this heavy keg up the hill for me.”

Now, Rip, though he was idle in his own home and did not like to do any hard work, was always ready to help other people. So he took the keg upon his shoulders and both the men began to trudge up the hill.

After a little while they came to a narrow valley among the hills. There Rip saw a crowd of men. They were playing a game of nine-pins and the balls, as they rolled along, made a noise like thunder.

Strange men they were too. One had a large head, a broad face and small eyes like the types of a pig. Another had a face which seemed to be all nose. The leader was a fat old fellow with a sun-burnt face. He wore a laced jacket, a broad belt, a sword, a high hat with a feather in it, red stockings and high heeled shoes.

As soon as the players saw the keg, they stopped their game. The little man who had come with Rip opened the keg and from it he poured out a drink for each of the men. Then he made a sign to Rip to hand out the cups.

The men drank eagerly, for their game had made them thirsty; then back they went to their game of nine-pins. Rip was thirsty too but they did not think of giving him a drink. So, when no one was looking, Rip took one sip from the keg.

‘A good drink, to be sure,’ he whispered to himself; then he took a little more and then a little more. Before long, Rip began to feel quite drowsy; then he fell fast asleep.

New Words to Learn



gentle – humble, willing – ready to help, favourite – beloved, glee – delight; joy, ill-clad – poorly dressed, astray – away from the right path, weeds – wild plants, grassy – covered with grass, trudge – march, narrow – slender, valley – vale, keg – small barrel, stocking – close fitting, heel – part of a shoe, eagerly – keenly, whispered – spoke in a low voice



ASSIGNMENT



Comprehension Skill

A. Multiple Choice Questions :

(Analytical Skills)

Tick (✓) the correct option :

- Rip was much favourite amongst the _____.
(i) people ☐ (ii) villagers ☐
(iii) children ☐ (iv) old man ☐
- He made _____ for them and taught them to fly kites and to play marbles.
(i) marbles ☐ (ii) toys ☐
(iii) dolls ☐ (iv) cars ☐
- The fences were broken down and his _____ were always going astray.
(i) cows ☐ (ii) sheep ☐
(iii) dogs ☐ (iv) goats ☐
- Rip lay down on a grassy bank and stayed there till late in the _____.
(i) afternoon ☐ (ii) evening ☐
(iii) night ☐ (iv) morning ☐

B. Fill in the blanks :

(Experiential Learning)

- He was always willing to _____ them in their work.
- He was some what _____ and did not like to do anything.
- This time did not go to the village as _____.
- The _____ called out again.
- Another had a _____ which seemed to be all nose.
- As soon as the players saw the keg, they _____ their game.

C. Write 'T' for true and 'F' for false :

(Critical Thinking)

- Rip was a cruel and rude person. ☐
- Rip's wife always praised her husband. ☐

3. Rip did not agree to carry the keg as he was lazy.
4. Rip saw a crowd of men in the narrow valley.
5. The strange man offered Rip a cup full of drinks.



D. Answer the following questions :

(Writing Skills)

1. Who was Rip Van Winkle? Where did he live?

2. Why did the villagers like him?

3. What was the thing that Rip disliked most?

4. Where did Rip go when his wife scolded him too much?

5. Who called Rip when he was returning home?

Enhance Your Vocabulary

- **Look for the meanings of the following words in the dictionary and write them alongside :**

(Critical Thinking)

1. glee _____

2. astray _____

3. ill-clad _____

4. grassy _____

5. weeds _____

6. keg _____

Let's Converse

- Rip Van Winkle was a simple villager. He was always ready to help others. The villagers loved him for his gentle behaviour and cooperative nature. He was favourite to the children as well. They liked him because he was just like a friend to them. He made toys for them and taught them to fly kites and to play marbles. He also told them fine tales of witches and fairies. However, his wife was not happy with him. To her, he was the laziest fellow. He never took interest in household works. His wife often scolded him for his indifference to household affairs but it had no effect on him.

Now, imagine that you have visited Rip's village as a reporter and collected information about him. Work in groups and prepare a report about Rip as you have heard from different sections of people. Write about three comments from each of them : (Communication Skills)

Rip's Wife : _____
 Villager : _____
 Village Children : _____

Enhance your Writing Skill

- Imagine that you were present there in the narrow valley and you had noticed the people playing the game of nine balls there. Describe the people and the game they played. (Writing Skills)

Check Your Language Skill

• Silent Letters

Some words have letters that we don't pronounce while reading them, such letters are called **silent letters**.

Example : **K**now, pa**l**m etc.

Now, encircle the silent letters in the following words and write them alongside. Remember there might be more than one silent letter in a word : (Phonics Skills)

Word	Silent Letter
1. knock	_____
2. wring	_____

3. write
4. honest
5. calm
6. debt
7. comb
8. lamb

Activity Time



- When Rip reached the narrow valley, he saw a crowd of men. They were playing a game of nine-pins. 'Nine-pins' is the name of a game which is played with a ball. Many other games are also played with a ball. Given below are the pictures of some ball games. Look at them carefully and identify the games. Also write the name of the game below each picture. You can take help from the help box :

(Creative Thinking)

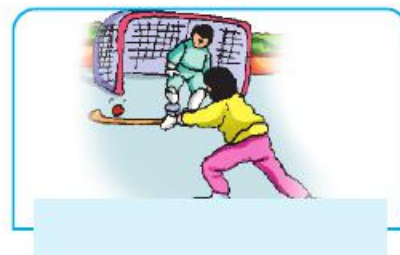
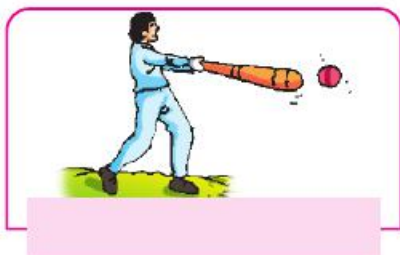
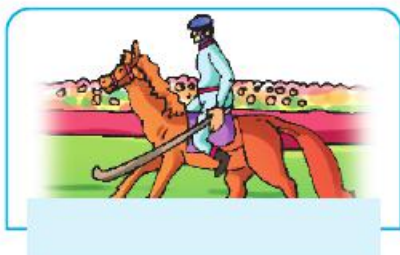
cricket
rugby

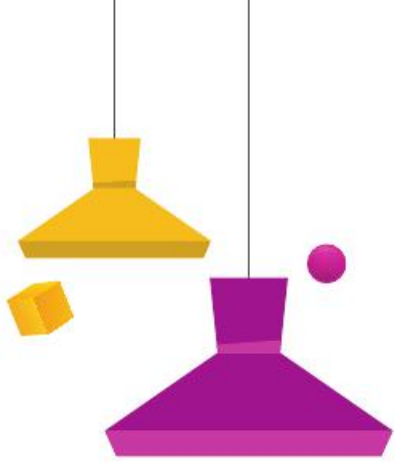
volleyball
hockey

polo
baseball

tennis
ice-hockey

football





10 Rip Van Winkle-II

When Rip opened his eyes, he found himself still on the green hillside. He rubbed his eyes in surprise. It was a bright sunny morning. The birds were hopping and chirping along the bushes and an eagle was flying high in the sky above his head.

"Oh, I must have slept all night," thought Rip. He looked around for the man who had been playing nine-pins but they were not there. His dog 'Wolf' had



vanished too, but his gun was still lying beside him. Rip was surprised to see that it was eaten away with rust and almost falling to pieces.

Rip stood up, lifted his rusty gun, and went to look for the men whom he had seen the night before. "They have played some mean trick on me," said he in anger. "I shall give them what they deserve."

For an hour or more Rip hunted among the hills and valleys but he could find neither the queer little men nor the valley where they had played their game. At last feeling very tired and stiff, he set off for the village. "I hope that Dame will half kill me for staying out all night," he thought, as he trudged along.

When Rip reached the village there was more surprises waiting for him. The shops were strange and the houses had changed.

Rip did not know the people whom he met in the village street and their clothes were of a kind which he had never seen before.

When the children saw Rip, who looked like a funny man, they laughed and chased him. The dogs also barked at him as he walked along. To tell the truth it was no wonder that they did, for Rip's beard had grown very thick and his clothes were tattered and torn.

At last Rip cried out to the people who stared at him, "I am Rip Van Winkle. Does nobody here know me?"



Just then, a young woman came along. "Did you say Rip Van Winkle?" She said. "My father was called by that name. One day when I was a little girl he went away to the hills with his dog, 'Wolf' and his gun. His dog came home without him but my poor father has not been seen since that day."

"How long ago was that, my good woman?" Asked Rip.

"Full twenty years ago," she answered.

"Twenty years!" Cried Rip. "Then I must have slept for twenty years on that hillside, though it seemed but one night to me. I am your father, Rip Van Winkle!" He cried to the young woman.

"The little men who played nine-pins must have been fairy men," Rip explained afterwards "and the drink which I took from the keg must have been a magic one that sent me to sleep for twenty years!"

Dame had died while Rip was away and Rip Van Winkle's house had fallen down, so he went to live with his daughter.

The rest of his life he spent in peace, telling stories to the village children and we may be sure they were all true and better stories.



New Words to Learn



sunny – full of sunlight, hopping – leaping, chirping – tweeting, vanished – disappeared, rust – corrosion, deserve – to be worthy of, queer – strange, mean trick – cunning action, trudged – walked slowly, chased – ran after, tattered – torn, stared – looked surprisingly



ASSIGNMENT



Comprehension Skill

A. Multiple Choice Questions :

(Analytical Skills)

Tick (✓) the correct option :

- The birds were hopping and chirping along the bushes and an _____ was flying high in the sky above his head.

(i) crow	☐	(ii) pigeon	☐
(iii) eagle	☐	(iv) parrot	☐
- For _____ hour or more Rip hunted among the hills and valleys but he could find neither the queer little men nor the valley where they had played their game.

(i) one	☐	(ii) two	☐
(iii) three	☐	(iv) four	☐
- When Rip reached the village there was more _____ waiting for him.

(i) children	☐	(ii) surprises	☐
(iii) people	☐	(iv) old man	☐
- Rip's beard had grown very thick and his clothes were _____.

(i) tattered	☐	(ii) clean	☐
(iii) dirty	☐	(iv) angry	☐

B. Fill in the blanks :

(Experiential Learning)

- He rubbed his eyes in _____.
- I shall give them what they _____.

3. This dog also _____ at him as he walked along.
4. His dog came home without his but my poor _____ has not been seen since that day.
5. He _____ to the young man.

C. Write 'T' for true and 'F' for false :

(Critical Thinking)

1. When Rip opened his eyes it was a cloudy morning.
2. Rip thought he has slept the whole night.
3. When he searched he could not find the little men.
4. His gun was full of rust.
5. A young woman came to Rip and said that she was his daughter.

D. Answer the following questions :

(Writing Skills)

1. Where did Rip find himself lying after he opened his eyes?

2. Why did Rip search for the strange man?

3. Why was Rip surprised when he reached his village?

4. What did the children do when they saw Rip? Why did they do so?

5. What did Rip say to the villagers?

Enhance Your Vocabulary

- **Look for the meanings of the following words in the dictionary and write them alongside :**

(Critical Thinking)

- | | |
|-------------------|-------------------|
| 1. chirping _____ | 2. vanished _____ |
| 3. trick _____ | 4. rust _____ |
| 5. trudged _____ | 6. tattered _____ |
| 7. deserve _____ | |

Let's Converse

- Rip Van Winkle slept for twenty long years under the influence of an unknown drink. When he returned to his village nobody, not even his daughter could recognize him. Work in pairs and frame an imaginary conversation that might have taken place between Rip Van Winkle and his daughter.** (Communication Skills)

Rip Van Winkle : _____

Daughter : _____

Rip Van Winkle : _____

Daughter : _____

Rip Van Winkle : _____

Daughter : _____

Rip Van Winkle : _____

Daughter : _____

Rip Van Winkle : _____

Daughter : _____

Enhance Your Writing Skill

- Imagine that you were one among the children in the Rip's village. Write in a few sentences why you found Rip funny and strange when he came after 20 years :** (Writing Skills)

Check Your Language Skill

- Homonyms**

There are certain words which are spelt or pronounced like another but have different meanings. Such words are called 'Homonyms'.

Example : still–steel, weather–whether, birth–berth etc.

Write the Homonyms of the following words and also use them in sentences of your own to show their difference : (Analyze)

1. Sea : _____

2. Sale : _____

3. Ship : _____

4. Plane : _____

5. Hare : _____

6. Idol : _____

7. Caste : _____

Activity Time

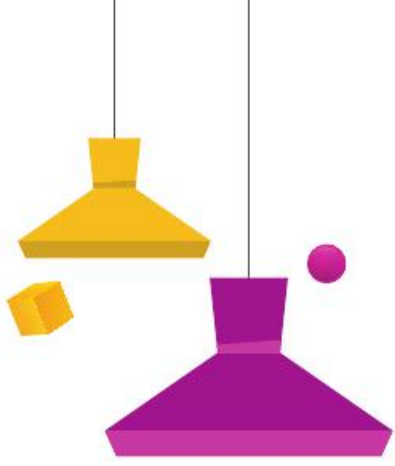


- **Rip Van Winkle slept for twenty years. When he came back to his village, he saw a lot of changes there. Describe in a sentence or two, at least three such changes that he might have noticed :** (Creative Thinking)

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

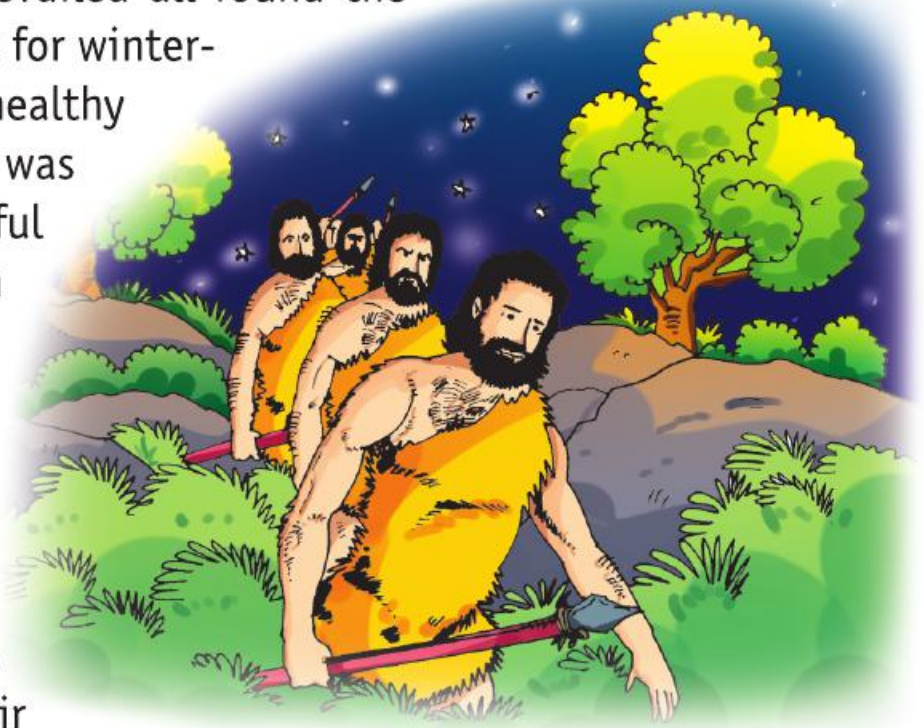


11

The Star and the Lilies

Long long ago, there was a time when this world was filled with happy people; when all the nations were as one, and the crimson tide of war had not begun to roll. Nobody was in want, for there was plenty of food in the forest and on the plains. Diseases were unknown. The animals, whether in the forests or in the fields, were tame; they came and went at the bidding of man. The spring season prevailed all round the year and there was no place for winter—for its cold blasts or its unhealthy chills. Every tree and bush was laden with fruit. Beautiful flowers covered the earth like a colourful carpet. The air was laden with their fragrance, and redolent with the songs of wedded warblers.

The birds in those days were more beautiful with their beautiful song and plumage than now. They flew freely from branch to branch singing their melodious song. There were none to harm them.



It was a time, when earth was like a paradise and men were really happy. They lived among the nature and enjoyed its many blessings. During the day, they roamed here and there in search of food and at night they met on the wide green beneath the heavenly worlds. They watched the stars; they loved to gaze at them, for they believed them to be the residences of the good, who had been taken home by the Great Spirits.

One night they saw one star that shone brighter than all others. Its location was far away in the south, near a mountain peak. For many nights they observed it with wonder. Many of them doubted that the star was as far distant in the southern skies as it seemed to be while there were others who thought it was very near; just above the mountain peak. They argued hard but could not arrive at any conclusion. At last, they decided to send some warriors to go and see where it was. So the warriors went to find out the truth and on return, they said that it was quite near and it appeared strange, and somewhat like a bird.

A committee of the wise men were formed to know more about it and, if possible, to ascertain the meaning of the strange phenomenon. They feared that it might be the omen of some disaster. Some thought it a precursor of good, others of evil; and some supposed it to be the star spoken of by their forefathers as the forerunner of a dreadful war.

Many days passed by but the mystery remained unsolved. One night the Chieftain of the community had a strange dream in which a beautiful maiden came and stood beside him. She said, "O good man of the earth, I am charmed with the land of yours, its flowers, its birds, its rivers, its beautiful lakes, and its mountains clothed with green, I have left my sisters in yonder world to dwell among you. Please ask your wise and great men whether they would allow me to stay here and if yes, where I can live and see the happy race continually. Also please ask them what form I shall assume in order to be loved by one and all."

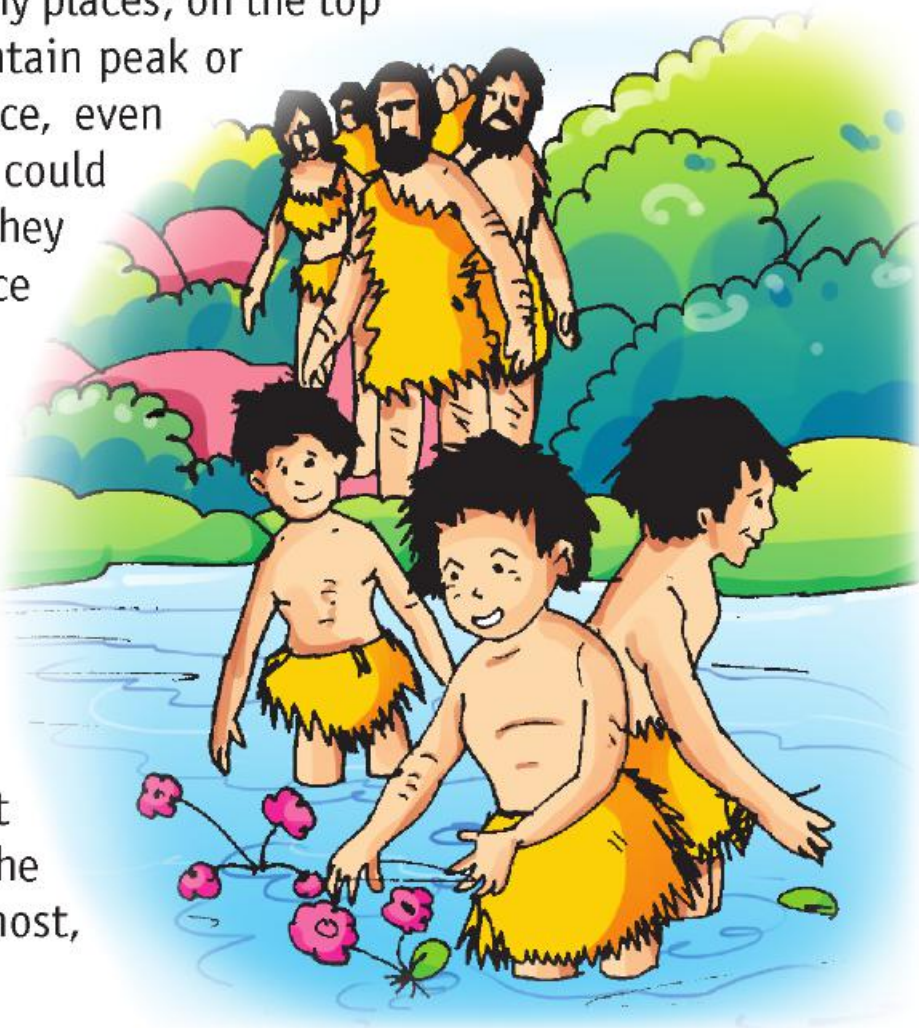
The Chieftain woke up. On stepping out of his lodge he saw the star yet blazing in its accustomed place. At early dawn, the announcer was sent

round the camp to call every wise man to the council lodge. When they had met, the Chieftain related his dream. They concluded that the star that had been seen in the south had fallen in love with mankind, and that she was desirous to dwell with them.

The next night five tall, noble-looking, adventurous brave warriors were sent to welcome the stranger to earth. They went near the mountain peak in the south and offered her a twig of olive tree as a token of love from the people on the earth. They were overjoyed when the star accepted their gift and returned happily to their village. As they were returning, the star, with expanded wings, followed, and hovered over their homes till the dawn of day. Again she came to the Chieftain in a dream and requested him to suggest the place where she should live and what form she should take.

When in the morning, the Chieftain put forth the issue before the council of wise men, they suggested many places; on the top of giant trees, over the mountain peak or in the colourful flowers. Since, even after a long discussion, they could not decide over the matter, they asked the star to choose a place herself, and she did so.

At first she dwelt in the white rose of the mountains; but there she was so buried that she could not be seen. Then she went to the grassy meadows; but she feared the hoof of the buffalo. She then sought the rocky cliff; but there she was so high that the children, whom she loved most, could not see her.



"I know where I shall live," said the bright star at last, "I know from where I can see the gliding canoe of the race I most admire. Children!.. Yes, they shall be my playmates, and I will kiss their slumber by the side of cool lake. The nation shall love me wherever I am."

With these words, the bright star alighted on the water of the cool lake, where she saw her reflection in the water. The next morning thousands of white flowers were seen on the surface of the lake, and the people gave them the name 'White Lily'.

This star lived in the southern skies. Her bothers can be seen far off in the cold north, hunting the Great Bear, while her sisters watch her in the east and west.

So dear children! When you see the lily on the water, take it in your hands and hold it to the skies, that it may be happy on earth, as its two sisters, the morning and evening stars are happy in heaven.

New Words to Learn



crimson – pink, tame – domestic, bidding – command, prevailed – existed, chills – cold, laden – loaded, redolent – scented, warblers – birds, plumage – feather, melodious – tuneful, warrior – soldier, ascertain – determine, precursor – forerunner, dwell – reside, accustomed – familiar, twig – stick, slumber – sleep, alighted – came down



ASSIGNMENT >>

Comprehension Skill

A. Multiple Choice Questions :

(Analytical Skills)

Tick (✓) the correct option :

1. The spring season prevailed all round the year and there was no place for _____ for its cold blasts or its unhealthy chills.

(i) winter

☐

(ii) summer

☐

(iii) spring

☐

(iv) monsoon

☐

2. One night they saw _____ that shone brighter than all others.

(i) two stars

(ii) one star

(iii) few stars

(iv) moon

3. Many days passed by but the _____ remained unsolved.

(i) mystery

(ii) confusion

(iii) problem

(iv) none of the above

7. This star lived in the _____ skies.

(i) southern

(ii) eastern

(iii) western

(iv) none of the above

B. Fill in the blanks :

(Experiential Learning)

1. Beautiful flowers _____ the earth like a colourful carpet.

2. They lived among the nature and _____ its many blessings.

3. One night they saw one star that shone _____ than all others.

4. The argued hard but couldn't _____ at any conclusion.

5. When they had met, the _____ related his dream.

C. Write 'T' for true and 'F' for false :

(Critical Thinking)

1. In those days, the air was laden with the fragrance of flowers, and redolent with the songs of wedded warblers.

2. The location of the bright star was far away in the north, near a mountain peak.

3. Many days passed by but the mystery remained unsolved.

4. Then she went to the grassy meadows; but she feared the hoof of the buffalo.

5. Finally, the bright star alighted in the water of the cool lake.

D. Answer the following questions :

(Writing Skills)

1. How was the world long ago as told in this lesson?

2. Write about the season and the birds described in the story.

3. What did the people see one night in the sky? Where was it located?

4. Why did they form a committee? What was their fear?

5. What was the name given by the people to the white flowers in the lake?

Enhance Your Vocabulary

- Look for the meanings of the following words in the dictionary and write them alongside : (Critical Thinking)

1. laden _____

2. plumage _____

3. conclusion _____

4. phenomenon _____

5. precursor _____

6. yonder _____

7. slumber _____

Let's Converse

- The bright star dwelled in the cool water of the lake in the form of white lily. A lily is a white flower that grows in water. Discuss with your partner and find out the names of the following flowers : (Communication Skills)

1. It is our National Flower. _____

2. This flower always changes its face towards the sun. _____

3. This flower is used to make garlands. _____

4. This flower blooms only at night. _____

5. It was the favourite flower of our first Prime Minister. _____

Enhance Your Writing Skill

- Have you ever watched the stars in the sky on a moonless night? What do you see there twinkling all the time? Why can't we see the stars during the day? Collect information and write then in a few lines : (Scientific Temper)

Check Your Language Skill

- Compound Words**

Compound Words are formed by joining two or more words. The word formed so, gives a different meaning than the words used to form it. Look at the following examples.

Example : Butter + fly = butterfly (an insect)
 : Sun + flower = sunflower (a flower)

Given below are two sets of words. Use them together and form a new word. Write the new word under the proper heading as shown in the example above:

(Analyze)

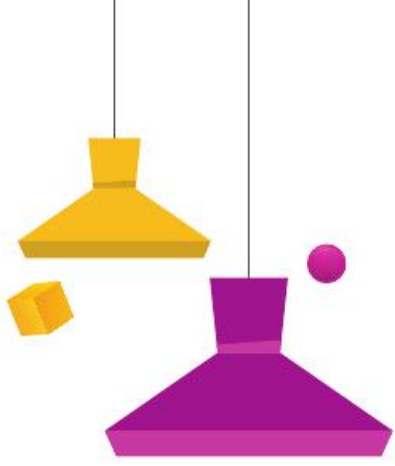
Word	Word	New Word
Earth	Maid	
After	Bag	
Milk	Shake	
Foot	Day	
Mango	Noon	
Sun	Ball	
Hand	Quake	

Activity Time



- Collect pictures of different types of white flowers and paste them in your scrapbook.**

(Creativity)



12

The Wooden Bowl

Kurt was an old man. He lived in a small town in Germany. Manfred, his son, Thekla, his daughter-in-law and Wilhelm, his little grandson all shared a little old house at the end of a quiet street in the middle of the town.

Kurt had been a good carpenter in his day. He had taught the art of carpentry to his son Manfred who had also become a master in the art. Manfred had set up a small workshop near his house. He was always busy and had little time to look after the affairs of the house.

He spent almost the whole day in the workshop making furniture for the people of the town and from time to time he did some carving as well. He earned a good living and lived happily.



Wilhelm, his only son, liked to sit in the workshop and watched his father working. As he grew older he helped his father by fetching and carrying things. He also learnt to clean the tools and to take care of them. He learnt how to use a saw and a hammer and a chisel. And his grandfather taught him to carve wood into wonderful shapes.

Kurt was getting older with every passing day. He was not very strong, his eyes were dim and he could not see well. Sometimes his hands shook, and sometimes he sat in a chair and nodded off to sleep. He was always sleeping.

In the evenings, when they all sat down to dinner at the table, Manfred and Thekla would often get angry with the old Kurt. He was slow and clumsy. Sometimes he broke a glass, sometimes he dropped a spoon, and again sometimes he spilt soup on his shirt and trousers. He was an old man, after all.

One day, the matter became worst. It was during their evening meal when suddenly, Kurt dropped his plate on the floor. Crash! It smashed into a hundred tiny pieces and the food fell all over the floor.

Thekla and Manfred began to clean up the floor. But how angry they were!

After that accident Manfred bought a cheap wooden bowl from the market.

They served him his dinner in that and made him sit by himself in the corner of



the room and by himself in the corner of the room and eat his food.

Kurt was sad, but what could he do? He kept quiet and did not complain.

A few days passed by, then one evening, after Thekla and Manfred had finished work for the day and were busy getting the evening meal prepared. When the meal was ready, they called for Wilhelm. They looked in his room, but he was not there. They searched here, there and everywhere but there was no trace of the boy.

"Where could that boy be?" Asked Thekla.

Manfred had no idea. He asked Kurt if he had seen Wilhelm, but the old man shook his head.

Thekla and Manfred became a little worried. They looked out on the street, but Wilhelm was not there. Suddenly, they saw a light coming out from the workshop and went to look.

As they stepped into the workshop, they found their son sitting there. He was cutting a small block of wood, and working as hard as he could.

"Ah! Here you are!" Said Thekla.

"What are you doing my son?" asked Manfred.

Wilhelm put down the block of wood and put down the chisel. He looked up at his parents.

"I am making a wooden bowl for you to eat for when you are old," replied the boy innocently. Thekla and Manfred looked at each other. Their eyes filled with tears. "Come



my son, dinner is ready,” said Thekla softly. And she put her arms round her son and the three of them went back to the house.

From that day, Thekla and Manfred always asked the old grandfather to sit with them at table.

New Words to Learn



quiet – calm and peaceful, workshop – a small place for manufacturing things, affairs – matters, carving – cutting and shaping wood, fetching – bringing, chisel – an instrument used for giving shape to wood, dim – not bright, clumsy – lacking skill or grace; awkward, split – scatter, smashed – broken, tiny – small, cheap – not expensive, complain – grumble, trace – sign, worried – afraid, innocently – unknowingly



ASSIGNMENT



Comprehension Skill

A. Multiple Choice Questions :

(Analytical Skills)

Tick (✓) the correct option :

1. Kurt lived in a small town in _____.
(i) Germany ☐ (ii) Italy ☐
(iii) France ☐ (iv) India ☐
2. Kurt had taught the art of _____ to his son Manfred who had also become a master in the art.
(i) fishing ☐ (ii) painting ☐
(iii) carpentry ☐ (iv) pellitory ☐
3. Wilhelm also learnt to clean the _____ and to take care of them.
(i) tools ☐ (ii) wood ☐
(iii) machines ☐ (iv) brushes ☐
4. Kurt was getting _____ with every passing day.
(i) older ☐ (ii) elder ☐
(iii) weaker ☐ (iv) younger ☐

B. Fill in the blanks :**(Experiential Learning)**

1. Kurt lived in a small town in _____ .
2. His _____ taught him to carve wood into wonderful shapes.
3. _____ and _____ began to clean up the floor.
4. They _____ here, there and but there was no of the body.
5. Their filled with _____ .

C. Write 'T' for true and 'F' for false :**(Critical Thinking)**

1. Kurt was Manfred's son.
2. Manfred had set up a small factory near his house.
3. Kurt taught Wilhelm to carve wood into wonderful shapes.
4. Sometimes Thekla became slow and clumsy.
5. Thekla and Manfred looked in his room, but he was not there.

D. Answer the following questions :**(Writing Skills)**

1. Who are the four characters in this story?

2. What was Kurt good at in his day?

3. What did Manfred do the entire days?

4. Who taught Wilhelm to carve wood into wonderful shapes?

5. Why did Kurt always sleep?

Enhance Your Vocabulary

- **Look for the meanings of the following words in the dictionary and write them alongside :**

(Critical Thinking)

- | | | | |
|-------------|-------|------------|-------|
| 1. workshop | _____ | 2. affairs | _____ |
| 3. chisel | _____ | 4. dim | _____ |

5. clumsy _____

6. nodded off _____

7. innocent _____

Let's Converse

(Analyze)

1. Kurt had taught the art of carpentry to his son Manfred who had also become a master in the art. Manfred learnt the art of carpentry from his father. How did he utilize that art?

Ans : _____

- (i) He taught it to his wife and son.
- (ii) He set up a workshop and made furniture there.
- (iii) He earned his living through carpentry.

2. Wilhelm, their only son, liked to sit in the workshop and watch his father working. As he grew older he helped his father by fetching and carrying things. Name some of the tools used in carpentry.

- (i) _____
- (ii) _____
- (iii) _____
- (iv) _____

3. Kurt had taught the art of carpentry to his son Manfred who had also become a master in the art. In the evenings, when they all sat down to dinner at the table, Manfred and Thekla would often get angry with the old grandfather because :

Ans : _____

- (i) He was slow and clumsy.
- (ii) Sometimes he broke a glass.
- (iii) Sometimes he split soup on his dress.

4. Kurt dropped his plate on the floor. Crash! It smashed into a hundred tiny pieces and the food fell all over the floor. What was the reaction of his son and daughter-in-law?

Ans : _____

- (i) They felt sorry for him and asked him not to worry.
- (ii) They became terribly angry but said nothing.
- (iii) They made him sit in a corner and served food in a cheap wooden bowl.

5. What is the moral of the story in your opinion?

Ans : _____

- (i) Everybody will become old some day so we should always treat the older members of the family with love and care.
- (ii) We should not regard them or obey their orders.
- (iii) We should keep them away from the family and avoid them.

Enhance Your Writing Skill

- **Do you have old grandparents? Where do they live? Do you meet them often or occasionally? What would you do for your grandparents to make them happy and comfortable? Describe in a few lines :** (Writing Skills)

Activity Time



- **How should we treat old persons? Why should we be sympathetic to them? Discuss in the class.** (Communication Skills)



13

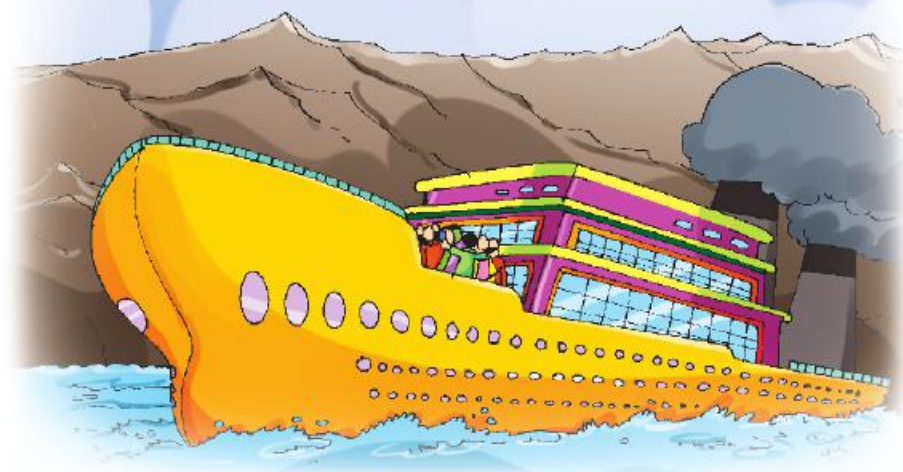
The Loss of Titanic



It was April 12, 1912, Titanic, the largest ship of the world was all set to sail from Southampton in England to New York in America. A large crowd had gathered in the harbour to see the ship off on its maiden voyage. The ship had already created sensation in the whole world. It was like a beautiful and amazing floating town. There were more than two thousand passengers on board of the ship. All were very excited. They were happy thinking that they would be remembered as the first passengers of the ship that would take them to America in the shortest possible time.

The people were surprised to see its enormous size. But not only was the size, everything about the ship was wonderful. It was a masterpiece in terms of beauty and comfort. The passengers could walk four and a half miles on it. There were ten decks rose tier on tier.

Inside the ship, there was a huge space; it was like a big hotel. There was a big dining hall with a capacity of more than five hundred people. There was a big swimming pool, a gymnasium, and a vast ballroom for the people. The White Star Line, the famous shipping company who had built it, had claimed that the ship would never sink.



Everything was going smooth. The passengers were proud thinking that they were on board the best ship in the world. There was music and dancing. Some people were in the ballroom enjoying a dance; some were in the dining room while some others were just standing on the deck staring at the deep blue sea. They were enjoying every moment of their journey. During its voyage, the ship had to pass through a very cold region; full of icebergs. Icebergs are huge blocks of ice floating on seawater. If the ship strikes against any of them, it would cause much damage.

Two days passed off peacefully. The ship was sailing smoothly, avoiding and dodging the icebergs. The passengers were also unconcerned. They had firm belief that the ship can face any problem.

It was April 14, around 11.30 p.m. midnight. The atmosphere was very cold, the sky was clear like crystal. The sea was also very calm. Most of the passengers were fast asleep in their cabins. Only the lookout men were awake, keeping a close watch from the crow's nest.



At around 11.40, three ringing of bells were heard. It was a sign of danger. Most of a in of ice, drifting slowly towards the ship. Sensing danger, the captain rushed to the the people woke up in panic. At the same time, a cry was heard from the crow's nest. Captain Jones also heard the cry. He

looked out of the path of the Titanic. There was a huge mountain of ice, drifting slowly towards the ship. Sensing danger, the captain rushed to the engine room and ordered to steer the ship away from the iceberg.

But it was too late; the iceberg had already hit the ship. The rough and sharp edges of the iceberg ripped the sides of the Titanic. Pieces of ice flew from the iceberg and fell on the decks like a shower of ice.

The sudden big jolt had waked up the passengers. They came running on the deck to know what had happened. The Captain told them of the collision but at the same time asked them not to worry, as the ship was unsinkable.

But soon the illusion was over; Captain Smith, the captain of the ship announced that Titanic was in trouble. It had hit an iceberg; and the ship was sinking.

The radio crew began to send frantic 'SOS' for help. There was another ship about twenty miles away from the Titanic. It was the California. Its lights could be seen at a distance, captain Jones was sure that the California would come for their help and the passengers would be saved. But unfortunately, the California's radio operator had gone to sleep. He didn't get the Titanic's signals for help. Many other ships also heard the signal and some of them

replied as well. But the nearest of them, Carpathia was about four hours away from the sinking ship.

By now, all the passengers had assembled on the deck. Panic gripped them. But they didn't know what to do.

Captain Jones was giving orders, 'Passengers, please fasten your life belts! Lower the lifeboats! Children and women first!' The crew lowered the lifeboats but it could hardly accommodate only a few hundred



people as against the total 2224 people on spot. But there was no trace of the Titanic; not even the lifeboats were visible. The unsinkable Titanic had sunk. After a lot of search, one of the lifeboats was seen. During the next few hours, all the lifeboats and their passengers were brought aboard the Carpathia.

In all, 711 passengers were saved, but another 1,513 people had died in the worst tragedy happened so far in the history of sea voyage.

New Words to Learn



sail – go across the sea, harbour – dock, voyage – journey on sea or space, amazing – astonishing, excited – thrilled, sensation – feeling, enormous – huge, masterpiece – work of genius, vast – very big, claimed – declared, smooth – easy, staring – looking, region – area, iceberg – an enormous block of floating ice, unconcerned – carefree, crow's nest – a place on a ship for keeping a watch, path – way, drifting – floating, ripped – slitted, collision – crash, illusion – false impression, gripped – engrossed, accommodate – make room for, visible – detectable, tragedy – disaster



ASSIGNMENT



Comprehension Skill

A. Multiple Choice Questions :

(Analytical Skills)

Tick (✓) the correct option :

1. A huge crowd had gathered in the _____ to see the ship off on its maiden voyage.
(i) harbour ☐ (ii) dock ☐
(iii) ground ☐ (iv) roof ☐
2. There were _____ rose tier on tier.
(i) ten decks ☐ (ii) twelve decks ☐
(iii) twenty decks ☐ (iv) nine decks ☐
3. The name of the shipping company that had built the ship was _____.
(i) White Star Line ☐ (ii) Blue Star Line ☐
(iii) Red Star Line ☐ (iv) none of the above ☐
4. _____ passed off peacefully.
(i) two days ☐ (ii) five days ☐
(iii) seven days ☐ (iv) eight days ☐
5. At around _____ three ringing of bells were heard.
(i) 11.40 ☐ (ii) 11.30 ☐
(iii) 12.30 ☐ (iv) 12.45 ☐
6. There was a huge mountain of ice, _____ slowly towards the ship.
(i) floating ☐ (ii) drifting ☐
(iii) coming ☐ (iv) none of the above ☐
7. The _____ sailed fast but even then it took her three hours to reach the exact spot.
(i) California ☐ (ii) Captia ☐
(iii) Carpathia ☐ (iv) none of the above ☐

B. Fill in the blanks :**(Experiential Learning)**

1. It was April 12, _____, Titanic.
2. There were more than _____ passengers on board of the ship.
3. There were _____ decks rose tier on tier.
4. There was _____ and _____.
5. It was April 14, around _____ P.M. midnight.
6. The captain of the ship announced that _____ was in the trouble.

C. Write 'T' for true and 'F' for false :**(Critical Thinking)**

1. It was April 12 1912, Titanic, the largest ship of the world was all set to sail from Southampton in England to New York in America.
2. There were more than five thousand passengers on board the ship.
3. During its voyage, the ship had to pass through a very cold region; full of icebergs.
4. Only the lookout men were awake, keeping a close watch from the crow's nest.
5. The Captain told them of the collision but at the same time asked them not to worry, as the ship was unsinkable.
6. The radio crew began to send frantic 'SOS' for help.

D. Answer the following questions :**(Writing Skills)**

1. When did the Titanic left on its maiden voyage?

2. Why had the Titanic created sensation in the whole world?

3. What was the claim of the shipping company which had built the Titanic?

4. What was the danger sensed by the captain? What did he try to do to save the people on the ship?

5. What happened to Titanic after it had hit an iceberg?

6. Why could the California not come to help the Titanic?

7. How many passengers were saved? How many of them died?

Enhance Your Vocabulary

A. Look for the meanings of the following words in the dictionary and write them alongside : (Critical Thinking)

1. enormous

2. vast

3. dodge

4. cabin

5. frantic

6. accommodate

7. fasten

B. Match the words in Column 'A' with their opposites in Column 'B' : (Analyze)

'A'

1. Largest

2. Excited

3. Comfort

4. Smooth

5. Assembled

6. Built

7. Tragedy

'B'

a. Rough

b. Upset

c. Joy

d. Dispersed

e. Destroyed

f. Bored

g. Smallest

Enhance your Writing Skill

- Imagine that you have met a passenger of the Titanic who narrated to you a detailed description of the harrowing tragedy. Write the description in your own words : (Writing Skills)

Check your language skill

- 'Yes', 'No' Questions**

Question : Do you take tea in the morning?

Affirmative : Yes, I do.

Negative : No, I don't.

Note that we have used only 'Yes' or 'No' to reply to the questions. Here, the meanings of the words 'do', or 'don't' stand for the remaining part of the reply which remains understood i.e. 'Yes, I take tea in the morning.' Or 'No, I don't take tea in the morning.'

Remember : We use 'does' instead of 'do' for singular subject.

Now, answer the following questions both in 'Yes' and 'No' : (Communication Skills)

1. Question : Does she come to your house everyday?

Affirmative : _____ Negative : _____

2. Question : Do you help your parents in the household works?

Affirmative : _____ Negative : _____

3. Question : Do they often go to Delhi by car?

Affirmative : _____ Negative : _____

4. Question : Does your brother help you in your homework?

Affirmative : _____ Negative : _____

Activity Time



- Have you ever gone to somewhere by a ship? Try to collect information about a ship, how it finds its way in the sea and how, in case of emergency, the crew of a ship communicate with other ships in the sea. (Creative Thinking)

Test Paper



A. Multiple Choice Questions :

Tick (✓) the correct option :

1. Midas was too fond of _____.
(i) money ☐ (ii) wealth ☐
(iii) gold ☐ (iv) silver ☐
2. Birbal knew that the man was badly in need of _____.
(i) food ☐ (ii) help ☐
(iii) money ☐ (iv) clothes ☐
3. Alice landed on a _____ of dry leaves.
(i) heap ☐ (ii) bunch ☐
(iii) pile ☐ (iv) leather ☐

B. Complete the following lines :

1. The crocuses _____
_____ window sills.
The grass _____
_____ pretty scene.
2. The birds are _____
_____ everyday.
The world _____
_____ is here!

C. Write 'T' for true and 'F' for false :

1. The crocuses and daffodils peep out from under the ground.
2. King Midas was eager to test his newly acquired boon.
3. They did not stop to listen to anybody and continued digging.
4. Birbal was very intelligent and possessed a sharp presence of mind.

D. Answer the following questions :

1. Who was King Midas? Where did he rule?
2. Why did King Midas ask the angel to take the boon back?
3. Who came out with an idea? Did the others like it?
4. How did Peter arrange food for the children?

Test Paper



A. Multiple Choice Questions :

Tick (✓) the correct option :

- Many years passed and Rain Cloud was getting _____.
(i) wiser ☐ (ii) weaker ☐
(iii) older ☐ (iv) small ☐
- When Rip reached the village there was more _____ waiting for him.
(i) children ☐ (ii) surprises ☐
(iii) people ☐ (iv) old man ☐
- At around _____ three ringing of bells were heard.
(i) 11.40 ☐ (ii) 11.30 ☐
(iii) 12.30 ☐ (iv) 12.45 ☐

B. Fill in the blanks :

- Rain cloud dragged the to the _____ river and ate him up.
- He was always willing to _____ them in their work.
- They lived among the nature and _____ its many blessings.
- His _____ taught him to carve wood into wonderful shapes.

C. Find out the words from the poem that rhyme with the words in column 'A' and write them in column 'B' :

Column 'A'	Column 'B'
1. high	_____
2. pass	_____
3. long	_____
4. call	_____
5. cold	_____

D. Answer the following questions :

- What made Rain Cloud vain and proud?
- Who was Rip Van Wrinkle? Where did he live?
- Why did Kurt always sleep?
- What was the claim of the shipping company which had built the Titanic?